

riemann-channel: lab book

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1 Frontmatter, Status Vocabulary, and Scope

1.1 Aim

This lab book records an attempt to formulate the Riemann hypothesis in the language of tensor networks and operational quantum mechanics: channels, Kraus operators, transfer matrices, matrix-product states. The aim is a formulation that captures the mechanisms of the proofs that exist (Weil for curves, Deligne for varieties over finite fields, Ihara–Bass and the Ramanujan property for regular graphs) and connects more directly to quantum mechanics than the Hilbert–Pólya programme does. Nothing here proves anything about the Riemann hypothesis. The Markdown notes under `notes/` are the exploratory record; this book is their distillation, and every statement here is tagged.

1.2 The organising picture

Every zeta function in sight has two sides. Side A is a nonnegative count of closed orbits (prime cycles of a graph, points of a curve, prime powers with weight $\log p$) and its Euler product; it is a product state, the primes do not talk to each other. Side B is a small non-Hermitian operator whose power sums reproduce the counts; its eigenvalues are the zeros. The Riemann hypothesis, in every instance, is the statement that all nontrivial eigenvalues of side B share one modulus. Section 2 fixes the notation and Section 3 the definitions used for both sides throughout.

1.3 Status vocabulary

Every theorem-like environment in this book carries exactly one status tag, printed at its right margin, equal to the status derived by `scripts/labbook_check.py` from `db/claims.tsv`:

- **proved**: a written proof exists under `notes/` and a reviewer other than the author has returned VERDICT `<id>`: `VALID` in a file under `notes/reviews/`. Both author and reviewers to date are Claude models (single family); no second model family has been used.
- **sketched**: written by the author, not yet attacked.
- **numerical**: established by a script whose output is captured under `outputs/`; never more than numerical evidence.
- **cited**: a statement of the literature, backed by a quote in `db/provenance.tsv` that the gate byte-checks against the arXiv TeX source under `refs/src/`.
- **conjectured**, **open**, **refuted**, **assumed**: as the words say; a claim that depends on any of the first three prints **unsupported**, and one that depends on an assumption prints with the suffix **-conditional**.

Definitions carry no tag; they are **stipulated** (ours) or **quoted** (a source’s, with provenance) in `db/definitions.tsv`. The derived-status table generated from the claims database is reproduced here.

id	kind	derived status	assumptions
<code>obs:one-identity</code>	observation	sketched	–
<code>obs:rh-finite-permutation</code>	observation	sketched	–
<code>obs:rh-small-matrix</code>	observation	sketched	–
<code>obs:rh-graph-ramanujan</code>	observation	sketched	–

id	kind	derived status	assumptions
obs:rh-mps-correlation-length	observation	sketched	-
obs:rh-flow-pairing	observation	sketched	-
obs:hilbert-polya-hermitian	observation	sketched	-
prop:scattering-inner	proposition	sketched	-
num:scattering-symbol	numerical	numerical	-
prop:functional-model-modes	proposition	sketched	-
prop:phase-identity	proposition	sketched	-
prop:ringnorm-trace	proposition	sketched	-
num:ringnorm-3000	numerical	numerical	-
prop:bc-mpo	proposition	sketched	-
num:bc-mpo	numerical	numerical	-
conj:stinespring-jump-form	conjecture	open	-
num:weil-lps-ramanujan	numerical	numerical	-
num:weil-lps-rh	numerical	numerical	-
prop:weil-lps-exactly-ramanujan	proposition	sketched	-
conj:weil-lps-hecke	conjecture	open	-
prop:as-transfer-matrix	proposition	sketched	-
prop:as-unitarity	proposition	sketched	-
num:artin-schreier-mps	numerical	numerical	-
obs:as-nonquadratic	observation	sketched	-
obs:deligne-ingredients	observation	sketched	-
obs:abelian-obstruction	observation	sketched	-
thm:qihara-general	theorem	proved	-
cor:qihara-kraus	corollary	proved	-
cor:qihara-unitary	corollary	proved	-
cor:qihara-poles	corollary	proved	-
obs:rh-iff-ramanujan-channel	observation	sketched	-
num:qihara-unitary	numerical	numerical	-
num:qihara-general	numerical	numerical	-
cit:mo-extended-ihara	citedfact	cited	-
cit:mo-adjoint-weights	citedfact	cited	-
cit:wf-arbitrary-weights	citedfact	cited	-
cit:bc-nonbacktracking	citedfact	cited	-
cit:harrow-transfer	citedfact	cited	-
cit:iyer-exact-ramanujan	citedfact	cited	-
cit:sunada-attribution	citedfact	cited	-
obs:prior-art-verdict	observation	sketched	-
conj:kraus-ramanujan	conjecture	open	-
conj:assemble-over-p	conjecture	open	-
obs:prime-by-prime-blind	observation	sketched	-
asm:fuchsian-geometry	assumption	assumed	-
asm:laplace-spectrum-compact	assumption	assumed	-
asm:selberg-zeta-entire	assumption	assumed	-
asm:heat-semigroup	assumption	assumed	-
asm:zeta-standard	assumption	assumed	-
asm:gamma-standard	assumption	assumed	-
cit:dz-guillemain	citedfact	cited	-
cit:dfg-band	citedfact	cited	-
cit:dz-ruelle-selberg	citedfact	cited	-
cit:marklof-trace	citedfact	cited	-
cit:fgkp-casimir-laplacian	citedfact	cited	-
cit:fjs-scattering-det	citedfact	cited	-

id	kind	derived status	assumptions
cit:mv-continuous-term	citedfact	cited	-
prop:circle-comb	proposition	proved	-
prop:prime-circles-orbital	proposition	proved	-
prop:finite-euler-spectrum	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:gamma-standard, asm:zeta-standa
prop:lindblad-sum-of-squares	proposition	proved	-
prop:casimir-laplacian	proposition	proved	-
prop:quantum-lindblad-tensor	proposition	proved	-
prop:poincare-jacobian	proposition	proved	-
prop:flat-tower	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:fuchsian-geometry
prop:tower-divisor-band	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:fuchsian-geometry, asm:laplace-
prop:graph-tower-ruelle	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:fuchsian-geometry, asm:selberg-
prop:cuspidal-prime-comb	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:gamma-standard, asm:zeta-standa
prop:damping-identity	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:gamma-standard, asm:zeta-standa
num:selberg-lindblad	numerical	numerical	-
obs:continuous-dictionary	observation	sketched-conditional	asm:fuchsian-geometry, asm:laplace-
conj:quantum-lindblad-gap	conjecture	open	-

1.4 Lockstep rules

The gate (`make check`; `make ci` adds a fresh build) fails unless: every note under `notes/` is named by a shard header and every shard header names an existing note; every evidence script is named by a shard and has a captured output; every theorem-like environment has one label, one claims row, and one status tag equal to the derived status; every definition has one row and appears once; the notation macros are exactly the generated image of `db/notation.tsv` with no duplicate symbols; every provenance quote is found whole and contiguous at its stated locus; and the build has no undefined references or citations.

2 Conventions and Notation

Every symbol below is a macro generated from `db/notation.tsv`; shards may not define macros of their own, and the gate warns whenever a shard writes a reserved control sequence (such as the bare Greek letters) bare instead of through its macro. The table is regenerated by `make regen` and the gate fails if it is stale.

2.1 Standing conventions

1. **Channel normalisation.** A channel Φ is normalised, $\Phi(X) = \frac{1}{D} \sum_i U_i X U_i^\dagger$, so that its leading eigenvalue is 1. The unnormalised sum is $\Sigma = \sum_i \mathcal{E}_i = D\Phi$. Every Ihara–Bass statement is written with Σ or $D\Phi$; the notes that wrote Φ without the $1/D$ are read with this convention.
2. **The size parameter q .** One letter, three roles that never co-occur: the field size in Section 8, the LPS prime in Section 7, and $D - 1$ for graphs and channels. In every role the critical modulus is $\sqrt{q}$. For a channel with D Kraus operators, $q := D - 1$ is a standing identification.
3. **Ramanujan units.** Spectral bounds are reported in adjacency units: a channel eigenvalue is multiplied by $D = q + 1$ and compared with $2\sqrt{q}$. Hastings’ bound $\lambda_H = 2\sqrt{D - 1}/D$ is the same statement in channel units.
4. **The zeta variable is u ,** in $\zeta_X(u)$, $\zeta_T(u)$, $Z_C(u)$ and $\det(1 - uT)$. The ring-length variable of the length flow is L , never $u = t/2$.
5. **Zeros.** A nontrivial zero is $\rho = \sigma + i\gamma$ with σ its real part; β is reserved for the inverse temperature of the Bost–Connes system. The Riemann hypothesis reads $\sigma = \frac{1}{2}$.
6. **Indices.** n is the matrix size in M_n and, in the ring pictures, the number of sites, which for Artin–Schreier curves is the extension degree of $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$. Walk, word and prime-cycle lengths are ℓ . Counts are N_ℓ .
7. **Column stacking.** $\text{Ad}(A) = \bar{A} \otimes A$ as an $n^2 \times n^2$ matrix, so $\text{Tr Ad}(A) = |\text{Tr } A|^2$.
8. **Non-backtracking operator.** $T(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \sum_{j \neq \bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i v \otimes |j\rangle$: the label i names the superoperator applied, and the next label may not be its reversal. Word products are composed right to left, $\mathcal{E}_{i_\ell} \cdots \mathcal{E}_{i_1}$, with the cyclic condition $i_{k+1} \neq \bar{i}_k$ for $k \in \mathbb{Z}/\ell$.
9. **Artin–Schreier sign.** $\alpha_i = -\lambda_i(E)$, so that $\mathcal{S}_n = -\sum_i \alpha_i^n$ for all n and $L = \prod_i (1 - \alpha_i u)$, the standard normalisation of the L -function of an exponential sum. The curve count is $N_n = q^n + 1 - \sum_i \alpha_i^n$.
10. **Canonical form.** An MPS is in (left) canonical form when $\sum_k A_k^\dagger A_k = 1$; then the transfer matrix has leading eigenvalue 1. The spectral normalisation used in the translation note (leading eigenvalue 1, rest inside the unit disc) is a consequence, not the definition.
11. **Status vocabulary.** The book uses only the tags of Section 3 (Definition 4.17). The two-value “established / not established” of the notes and the prior-art verdicts (**SAME**, **RELATED**, **NOT**) are read as **sketched/numerical** versus **open**, and as a provenance vocabulary confined to Section 11, respectively.
12. **Trace.** Tr is the operator trace; the field trace is $\text{tr}_{q^n/q}$.

2.2 Clashes found and resolved

The extraction of 2026-09-12 (`notes/extract/notation-and-definitions.md`) found 146 symbols across the seven notes, with these collisions. Each resolution below is what the table enforces.

- ψ carried five meanings: Chebyshev function, additive character, Lévy exponent, digamma, MPS ring state. Now: ψ is Chebyshev; e_q the additive character; κ_σ the Lévy exponent; (Γ'/Γ) the digamma; Ψ_n the ring state.
- T carried five: the non-backtracking operator, the length-flow generator, the curve-zeta variable, the Heisenberg–Weyl operator, the Hecke operator. Now: T is the non-backtracking operator; $\mathcal{G}$ the generator; u the variable; $T(u, v)$ the Heisenberg–Weyl operator (only with two arguments); A_q the Hecke adjacency operator.
- ρ carried three: zero, density matrix, twist. Now: ρ is a zero; X a channel input; ϱ a twisting representation.
- β carried three: real part of a zero, inverse temperature, Deligne weight. Now: σ , β , w .
- ξ was both the completed zeta and the correlation length, within two pages. Now: ξ is the completed zeta; ℓ_k^c the correlation length; ϑ_k the phase.
- S was the scattering symbol, the exponential sum and the start map. Now: S , $\mathcal{S}_n$, $\mathbf{S}$.
- J was the Artin–Schreier range, the reversal operator and a splitting matrix. Now: J (italic), J (sans-serif), $\mathbf{J}$ (bold).
- D was the Kraus count, the dilation unitary, a diagonal degree matrix and the degree operator. Now: D , $\mathbf{D}$, and $\mathcal{D}(u)(u)$; the diagonal degree matrix of a general graph is never needed on a bouquet.
- E was the MPS transfer matrix and the Artin–Schreier transfer matrix (the same concept, kept as E) and the superoperators of a Kraus family (now $\mathcal{E}_i$, a different glyph).
- W, V : the edge and vertex spaces of the non-backtracking construction are $\mathcal{W}, \mathcal{V}$; $W(g)$ and $W_\pm$ are the Weil representation and its blocks; $|V|$ is a vertex count.
- A : the adjacency matrix A ; Kraus operators A_i ; the LPS Hecke adjacency A_q .
- F : the Fourier transform $\mathcal{F}$; Frobenius Fr ; the numerical window sum F ; Weil’s zero-side function F_W .
- M : a generic matrix M ; the chirp $\mathbf{M}$.
- σ : the real part of s ; the reversal involution is now ι . Σ is only ever $\Sigma = D\Phi$.
- α : Frobenius eigenvalues carry a subscript, α_i ; a quaternion is bare α .
- m : the number of Kraus pairs; walk length is ℓ . N : $\dim \mathcal{V}$; counts are N_ℓ .
- μ : an edge eigenvalue; the Bost–Connes isometries are $\mathfrak{m}_n$. G : a group; the window width is G_w . θ : the normal-basis generator θ ; phases are ϑ_k . s : the complex variable; a square root of $q \bmod p$ is s_q .

2.3 Notation table

symbol	meaning	domain	where
Tr	trace	general	RC-01
Ad	adjoint action, $\text{Ad}(A): X \rightarrow A X A^\dagger$	channels	RC-01
Re	real part	general	RC-01
Im	imaginary part	general	RC-01
M_n	$n \times n$ complex matrices with the Hilbert-Schmidt inner product	channels	RC-01
$\mathcal{V}$	vertex space of the non-backtracking construction ($V = M_n$ in the channel case), $N = \dim V$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
$\mathcal{W}$	edge space $V(x) \hat{C}^D$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
T	non-backtracking (Hashimoto) edge operator, classical on directed edges or quantum on the edge space	graphs, quantum Ihara	RC-02
$\mathcal{G}$	generator of the length flow whose trace is the prime measure, eigenvalues 1, ρ , $-\rho$, $-\rho^2$, ...	Riemann channel	RC-03
$\mathcal{E}_i$	i -th superoperator of a family ($E_i = \text{Ad}(A_i)$ in the Kraus case)	quantum Ihara	RC-08
A_i	i -th Kraus operator	channels	RC-01
U_i	i -th unitary Kraus operator	channels	RC-01
Σ	unnormalised transfer matrix $\sum_i E_i$ ($= D \Phi$ for a unital channel)	channels, MPS	RC-01
Φ	unital channel $(1/D) \sum_i U_i X U_i^\dagger$, or a general channel	channels	RC-01
D	number of Kraus operators ($=$ degree of the bouquet); $D = 2m$	channels	RC-01
m	number of Kraus pairs, $D = 2m$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
ι	fixed-point-free reversal involution on the index set $[D]$, $\bar{i} = \iota(i)$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
$\bar{\cdot}$	reversed index $\iota(i)$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
J	backtracking operator $J(v(x) i\rangle) = E_i v(x) \bar{i}\rangle$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
R	propagate-along-edge map $R: W \rightarrow V$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
S	start-any-edge map $S: V \rightarrow W$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
$\mathcal{A}(u)$	deformed adjacency $u \sum_i E_i (1 - u^\dagger)^2 E_{\bar{i}} E_i \hat{\cdot}^{-1}$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
$\mathcal{D}(u)$	deformed degree $u^\dagger \sum_i E_{\bar{i}} E_i (1 - u^\dagger)^2 E_{\bar{i}} E_i \hat{\cdot}^{-1}$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
ζ_T	zeta function $\det(1 - uT) \hat{\cdot}^{-1}$ of a non-backtracking operator	quantum Ihara	RC-08
ζ_Φ	quantum Ihara zeta of a unital channel with unitary Kraus operators	quantum Ihara	RC-02
ζ_X	Ihara zeta of a graph X	graphs	RC-02
A	adjacency matrix of a graph	graphs	RC-02
$A.$	adjacency operator of the LPS Cayley graph for norm- q quaternions (Hecke operator)	Weil-LPS	RC-05
q	size parameter: field size (Artin-Schreier), LPS prime (Weil-LPS), and $D - 1 = \text{degree} - 1$ for graphs and channels	all	RC-01
p	a rational prime; the modulus of the Weil representation in RC-05	all	RC-01

symbol	meaning	domain	where
λ_2	second largest eigenvalue (or singular value) of a channel or graph, normalised to leading eigenvalue 1	expanders	RC-02
λ_H	Hastings bound $2 \sqrt{(D-1)/D}$	expanders	RC-02
μ	eigenvalue of the edge operator T ; pairs $\mu \mu' = q$ with an adjacency eigenvalue λ	graphs	RC-02
ℓ	length of a walk, word or prime cycle	graphs, quantum Ihara	RC-02
N_ℓ	closed non-backtracking walk count of length ℓ , or point count over F_{q^ℓ}	graphs, curves	RC-02
P	prime cycle of a graph (primitive closed non-backtracking walk up to rotation)	graphs	RC-02
Fr	Frobenius	curves	RC-06
ϱ	representation twisting a zeta (holonomy, Artin-Ihara twist, adjoint representation)	graphs, Deligne	RC-07
X	density matrix or general operator input of a channel	channels	RC-01
ρ	nontrivial zero of zeta, $\rho = \sigma + i \gamma$	number theory	RC-01
σ	real part of s (or of a zero)	number theory	RC-01
γ_n	imaginary part of the n -th zero	number theory	RC-01
ξ	completed zeta $\xi(s) = (1/2) s(s-1) \pi^{\hat{s}/2} \Gamma(s/2) \zeta(s)$	number theory	RC-04
S	Lax-Phillips scattering symbol $S(\tau) = \xi(1 - 2i\tau)/\xi(1 + 2i\tau)$	Riemann channel	RC-04
τ	Mellin variable on the dilation group; dilation by $e^{\hat{t}}$ acts as $e^{\hat{t}}$	Riemann channel	RC-04
K_S	model space $H^{\hat{2}} \ominus S H^{\hat{2}}$	Riemann channel	RC-04
$Z(t)$	compressed dilation semigroup $P_{K_S} e^{\hat{t}}$ restricted to K_S	Riemann channel	RC-04
Λ	von Mangoldt function	number theory	RC-01
ψ	Chebyshev function $\psi(x) = \sum_{n \leq x} \Lambda(n)$	number theory	RC-03
e_q	additive character of F_q composed with the trace	curves	RC-06
κ	Bost-Connes Levy exponent $\kappa_\sigma(\tau) = \log \zeta(\sigma - i\tau) - \log \zeta(\sigma)$	Bost-Connes	RC-04
ν	von Mangoldt jump measure $\nu_\sigma = \sum p^{-k\sigma} / k \log p$	Bost-Connes	RC-04
β	inverse temperature of the Bost-Connes system	Bost-Connes	RC-04
L	ring length variable of the length flow (prime powers sit at $L = \log n$)	Riemann channel	RC-03
F	windowed zero sum $F(u)$ of the ring-norm test	Riemann channel	RC-04
E	transfer matrix of a matrix product state (the Artin-Schreier transfer matrix is the instance of RC-06)	MPS, curves	RC-02
Ψ	periodic matrix product state on n sites	MPS	RC-02
$\langle \Psi \Psi \rangle$	ring norm of the periodic n -site state, $= \text{Tr } E^{\hat{n}}$	MPS	RC-02
ℓ_k^c	k -th correlation length of a transfer matrix	MPS	RC-03
h	entropy per site (log of the leading eigenvalue)	MPS	RC-03
$\mathbb{F}_q$	finite field with q elements	curves	RC-01

symbol	meaning	domain	where
$\mathbb{F}_p$	finite field with p elements	curves, Weil-LPS	RC-01
$\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$	extension of degree n	curves	RC-06
$\mathcal{S}$	exponential sum $S_n(g) = \sum_{x \in \mathbb{F}_q} \{g(x)\}^n$	curves	RC-06
J	range of the quadratic Artin-Schreier polynomial, $\dim E = q^{\frac{1}{2}}J$	curves	RC-06
α	Frobenius eigenvalues (roots of the L-polynomial), $ \alpha = \sqrt{q}$	curves	RC-06
SL_2	special linear group	Weil-LPS	RC-05
PSL_2	projective special linear group	Weil-LPS	RC-05
W	Weil representation $W(g)$ of $SL_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ on $\ell^2(\mathbb{F}_p)$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
$W_{\pm}$	even and odd blocks of the Weil representation, dimensions $(p \pm 1)/2$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
Φ	Weil-LPS channel for the LPS prime q (with superscript pm for the block)	Weil-LPS	RC-05
α	integer quaternion of norm q in the LPS normalization	Weil-LPS	RC-05
g_{α}	image of the quaternion α in $SL_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
Z	clock operator on $\ell^2(\mathbb{F}_p)$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
X	shift operator on $\ell^2(\mathbb{F}_p)$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
$\mathcal{F}$	Fourier transform on $\ell^2(\mathbb{F}_p)$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
M	chirp operator $\text{diag } e_p(x^2/2)$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
D	dilation unitary on $\ell^2(\mathbb{F}_p)$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
I	splitting matrix $I = ((x, y), (y, -x))$ with $x^2 + y^2 + 1 = 0 \pmod{p}$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
J	splitting matrix $J = ((0, 1), (-1, 0))$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
$T(u, v)$	Heisenberg-Weyl operator $X^u Z^v$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
c	pointwise weight scalar of a twisted coefficient system ($ \text{eigenvalue} = c^{\frac{1}{\ell}}$)	Deligne	RC-07
L	L-function (of a curve with coefficients, or Artin-Ihara)	graphs, curves	RC-02
(Γ'/Γ)	digamma function in the archimedean term of the explicit formula	number theory	RC-04
w	weight of a pure coefficient system ($ \text{Frobenius eigenvalue} = q^{\frac{1}{2}w}$)	Deligne	RC-07
$\text{tr}_{q^n/q}$	field trace from $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ to $\mathbb{F}_q$	curves	RC-06
Z_C	zeta function of a curve C over $\mathbb{F}_q$, $\exp \sum_n N_n u^n / n$	curves	RC-06
G_w	Gaussian window width of the ring-norm test	Riemann channel	RC-04
F_W	zero-side function $\sum_{\rho} e^{\frac{1}{2}(\rho - 1/2)u}$ whose positive-definiteness is Weil's criterion	number theory	RC-03
ϑ	k -th oscillation frequency of a transfer matrix, $\lambda_k = \exp(-1/\ell^2 c_k + i \vartheta_k)$	MPS	RC-03
θ	generator of a normal basis of $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$	curves	RC-06
s_q	a square root of q modulo p	Weil-LPS	RC-05
m	Bost-Connes isometry μ_n	Bost-Connes	RC-04
U	Shor's unitary $x \mapsto ax \pmod{N}$, the level- N Galois symmetry of Bost-Connes	Bost-Connes	RC-04

symbol	meaning	domain	where
$\hat{g}$	test window in the explicit formula (Fourier transform g)	number theory	RC-04
t	semigroup time in $Z(t)$; dilation by $e^{\hat{t}}$	Riemann channel	RC-04
u	the zeta variable, in $\text{zeta}_X(u)$, $\text{zeta}_T(u)$, $Z_C(u)$, $\det(1 - uT)$	all	RC-01
$\ell^2(\cdot)$	Hilbert space of square-summable functions on a set	general	RC-01
$\mathcal{O}_{Dw}$	Dwork's p-adic transfer operator, multiplication by the splitting function then decimation	curves	RC-06
dec_q	decimation $x^{\hat{m}} \rightarrow x^{\hat{m}/q}$ on p-adic power series	curves	RC-06
ℓ -adic	ell-adic (cohomology); this ell is not a walk length	Deligne	RC-06
$\mathcal{X}$	generator of the geodesic flow on $\Gamma \backslash G$, $X = H/2$ through left-invariant fields; $(e^{\hat{t}} \cdot X)(m) = f(\phi_{-t} m)$	Selberg	RC-09B
H	left-invariant field of $H = \text{diag}(1, -1)$	Selberg	RC-09B
E	left-invariant field of $E = ((0, 1), (1, 0))$	Selberg	RC-09B
W	left-invariant field of $W = ((0, 1), (-1, 0))$, the compact direction	Selberg	RC-09B
Ω	Casimir $(1/4)(H^{\hat{2}} + E^{\hat{2}} - W^{\hat{2}})$	Selberg	RC-09B
Δ	positive hyperbolic Laplacian $-\hat{y}^2(d_x^{\hat{2}} + d_y^{\hat{2}})$	Selberg	RC-09B
λ_j	j-th Laplace eigenvalue, $\lambda_j = 1/4 + r_j^{\hat{2}}$	Selberg	RC-09B
r	spectral parameter of λ_j ; $r_0 = i/2$ for the constant mode, $r_j = i \nu_j$ for exceptional eigenvalues	Selberg	RC-09B
Z_{Sel}	Selberg zeta $\prod_{\gamma} \prod_{k \geq 0} (1 - e^{\hat{t}} \cdot (s+k) \ell_{\gamma})$	Selberg	RC-09B
ζ_R	Ruelle zeta $\prod_{\gamma} (1 - e^{\hat{t}} \cdot s \ell_{\gamma}) = Z_{\text{Sel}}(s)/Z_{\text{Sel}}(s+1)$	Selberg	RC-09B
P_{γ}	linearised Poincare map of the closed geodesic γ	Selberg	RC-09B
Tr^b	Guillemin flat trace	Selberg	RC-09B
ς	Laplace variable of the flat trace (the resonance variable), never the Selberg variable s	Selberg	RC-09B
Λ_{fl}	Laplace transform of the flat trace, $\int_0^{\infty} e^{\hat{t} \cdot \text{varsigma}} \text{Tr}^{\text{flat}}(e^{\hat{t}} \cdot X) dt$	Selberg	RC-09B
D_{tow}	the tower $\prod_{j \geq 1} Z_{\text{Sel}}(\text{varsigma} + j)$, the flat dynamical determinant	Selberg	RC-09B
$\mathcal{B}_0$	nonconstant first band $\{-1/2 + i r_j : j \geq 1\}$	Selberg	RC-09B
φ	scattering determinant of $\text{PSL}(2, \mathbb{Z})$, $\sqrt{\pi} \Gamma(s-1/2) \zeta(2s-1)/(\Gamma(s) \zeta(2s))$	modular	RC-09B
m_{sc}	scattering multiplier $-(1/2)(\varphi'/\varphi)(1/2 + i r)$	modular	RC-09B
C_{cusp}	inverse Fourier transform of the scattering multiplier	modular	RC-09B
P_+	positive-time prime measure $\sum_n \Lambda(n)/n \delta(t - 2 \log n)$	modular	RC-09B
P_{ch}	prime measure $\sum_n \Lambda(n) n^{\hat{t}-1/2} \delta(t - 2 \log n)$ of the Riemann-channel note	modular	RC-09B

symbol	meaning	domain	where
A_{arch}	archimedean-plus-boundary distribution $1/(4 \sinh(t /2))$ away from zero	$1/2 -$ modular	RC-09B

3 Definitions

Each definition appears exactly once in the book. The column `merged_from` of `db/definitions.tsv` lists the notes and sections whose wordings were merged; where the wordings differed in substance, the difference is stated in the definition.

3.1 The two sides

Definition 3.1 (Side A and side B). For a zeta function written as $\exp \sum_{\ell \geq 1} N_\ell u^\ell / \ell$ with nonnegative counts N_ℓ , *side A* is the gas of rings: the counts, their Euler product over primitive closed orbits, and the product state they form. *Side B* is a transfer operator whose power sums reproduce the counts, $N_\ell = \text{Tr } T^\ell$ (or a semigroup $\text{Tr } e^{\text{L}\mathcal{G}}$ in continuous length); its eigenvalues are the poles and zeros.

Definition 3.2 (The one identity). For any matrix M with eigenvalues $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_N$, $1/\det(1-uM) = \prod_i (1 - \lambda_i u)^{-1} = \exp \left(\sum_{\ell \geq 1} \text{Tr}(M^\ell) u^\ell / \ell \right)$. The middle term is a bosonic partition function with one mode per eigenvector; the right term a sum over closed walks with the $1/\ell$ of a ring's rotation symmetry.

Definition 3.3 (Small matrix). For a shift or permutation with fixed-point counts $\text{fix}(\ell)$ of its ℓ -th power, a *small matrix* is any matrix M_{small} with $\text{Tr } M_{\text{small}}^\ell = \text{fix}(\ell)$ for all ℓ . It exists exactly when the zeta function is rational, and its eigenvalues are not those of the permutation matrix.

Definition 3.4 (RH analogue, Ramanujan property). A side-B operator with leading eigenvalue $\lambda_{\max}$ (or leading growth q per step) satisfies the *RH analogue* when every other nonzero eigenvalue has modulus $\sqrt{\lambda_{\max}}$ (respectively $\sqrt{q}$). In counting terms the fluctuation of the counts is the square root of the leading term. For graphs this is the Ramanujan property; for the Riemann zeta it is the Riemann hypothesis; for an MPS it is one correlation length equal to $2/h$.

3.2 Graphs

Definition 3.5 (Non-backtracking walk, prime cycle). A walk in a graph is non-backtracking if it never immediately retraces an edge; closed in the strong sense means the last step is not the reverse of the first. A *prime cycle* P is a closed non-backtracking walk that is not a repetition of a shorter one, taken up to choice of starting point; $\ell(P)$ is its length. On a bouquet with $D/2$ loops the directed edges are $[D]$ and a closed non-backtracking walk is a cyclically reduced word.

Definition 3.6 (Ihara zeta). For a finite graph X with N_ℓ closed non-backtracking walks of length ℓ , $\zeta_X(u) = \exp \left(\sum_{\ell} N_\ell u^\ell / \ell \right) = \prod_P (1 - u^{\ell(P)})^{-1}$.

Definition 3.7 (Hashimoto operator). The *Hashimoto* (non-backtracking edge) operator of a graph is the matrix T on directed edges with $T_{ef} = 1$ when f can follow e without backtracking; then $N_\ell = \text{Tr } T^\ell$ and $\zeta_X(u) = \det(1 - uT)^{-1}$.

Definition 3.8 (Ihara–Bass formula). For a $(q+1)$ -regular graph with adjacency matrix A on $|V|$ vertices and $|E|$ undirected edges, $\det(1 - uT) = (1 - u^2)^{|E|-|V|} \det(1 - uA + qu^2)$. Each adjacency eigenvalue λ produces two eigenvalues μ, μ' of T with $\mu\mu' = q$, $\mu + \mu' = \lambda$; the eigenvalue $q+1$ gives $\mu \in \{q, 1\}$.

Definition 3.9 (Ramanujan graph). A $(q+1)$ -regular graph is *Ramanujan* when every adjacency eigenvalue other than $\pm(q+1)$ satisfies $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$, the spectral radius of the universal covering tree. Equivalently all nontrivial μ satisfy $|\mu| = \sqrt{q}$, which is the RH analogue for ζ_X .

Definition 3.10 (Artin–Ihara L -function). For a graph with a representation ϱ of its fundamental group assigned to closed walks (a holonomy), $L(u, \varrho) = \prod_P \det(1 - \varrho(P)u^{\ell(P)})^{-1}$, where the product is over prime cycles. For a bouquet the fundamental group is free and ϱ is a choice of one operator per loop.

3.3 Channels and matrix product states

Definition 3.11 (Channel, Kraus operators). A *channel* on M_n is a completely positive trace-preserving map $\Phi(X) = \sum_i A_i X A_i^\dagger$ with $\sum_i A_i^\dagger A_i = 1$; the A_i are its Kraus operators. It is *unital* when $\Phi(1) = 1$ and *mixed-unitary* when $A_i = D^{-1/2} U_i$ with unitary U_i , in which case $\Phi(X) = \frac{1}{D} \sum_i U_i X U_i^\dagger$ and the family is taken closed under adjoint.

Definition 3.12 (Transfer matrix of an MPS). For a matrix product state with local tensors $A_1, \dots, A_d \in M_n$ (physical dimension d , bond dimension n), the *transfer matrix* is $E = \sum_i \text{Ad}(A_i) = \Sigma$, acting on M_n .

Definition 3.13 (Ring norm). The *ring norm* of the periodic n -site state Ψ_n built from the tensors is $\langle \Psi_n | \Psi_n \rangle = \text{Tr } E^n$; the zeta function of the state is the generating function $\exp \sum_n \langle \Psi_n | \Psi_n \rangle u^n / n = \det(1 - uE)^{-1}$.

Definition 3.14 (Canonical form). An MPS is in (left) canonical form when $\sum_k A_k^\dagger A_k = 1$, i.e. when E is the transfer matrix of a channel; then E has leading eigenvalue 1 and the remaining eigenvalues lie in the closed unit disc.

Definition 3.15 (Correlation length). In canonical form write the subleading eigenvalues as $\lambda_k = e^{-1/\ell_k^c + i\vartheta_k}$; the ℓ_k^c are the correlation lengths and the ϑ_k the phases. The entropy per site is $h = \log \lambda_{\max}$ of the unnormalised transfer matrix.

Definition 3.16 (Quantum expander). A channel with D Kraus operators is a (n, D, λ) *quantum expander* when 1 is its unique fixed point (up to scale) and every other eigenvalue has modulus at most $\lambda < 1$.

Definition 3.17 (Ramanujan quantum expander). A quantum expander is *Ramanujan* when $\lambda_2 \leq \lambda_H$, where, in Hastings' words, $\lambda_H = \frac{2\sqrt{D-1}}{D}$. (provenance `prov:hastings07-bound`); in adjacency units, $D\lambda_2 \leq 2\sqrt{D-1}$.

Definition 3.18 (Quantum Hashimoto operator, quantum Ihara zeta). For superoperators $\mathcal{E}_1, \dots, \mathcal{E}_D$ on $\mathcal{V}$ and a fixed-point-free reversal ι on $[D]$, the *quantum Hashimoto operator* is T on $\mathcal{W} = \mathcal{V} \otimes \mathbb{C}^D$, $T(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \sum_{j \neq \iota i} \mathcal{E}_i v \otimes |j\rangle$, and $\zeta_T(u) = \det(1 - uT)^{-1}$. For a mixed-unitary channel, $\mathcal{E}_i = \text{Ad}(U_i)$ with $U_{\bar{i}} = U_i^\dagger$, and the zeta is written ζ_Φ : the *quantum Ihara zeta* of the channel. It is the Artin–Ihara L -function of the bouquet twisted by $\varrho = \text{Ad} \circ U$.

4 Definitions, Continued

Continuation of Section 3; split for length only.

4.1 The Riemann channel

Definition 4.1 (Scattering symbol). With $\xi(s) = \frac{1}{2}s(s-1)\pi^{-s/2}\Gamma(s/2)\zeta(s)$ and τ the Mellin variable on the dilation group, the *scattering symbol* of the modular surface is $S(\tau) = \xi(1-2i\tau)/\xi(1+2i\tau)$.

Definition 4.2 (Inner function, model space, compressed semigroup). A function analytic and bounded by 1 in the lower half plane with unimodular boundary values is *inner*. For inner S the *model space* is $K_S = H^2 \ominus SH^2$ and the *compressed semigroup* is $Z(t) = P_{K_S} e^{it\tau}|_{K_S}$, $t > 0$.

Definition 4.3 (Riemann channel). The *Riemann channel* is the completely positive semigroup $X \mapsto Z(t)^* X Z(t)$ on $B(K_S)$, whose single Kraus operator is the compressed semigroup of the scattering symbol. Its modes are the zeros of ζ and its distributional trace is the prime measure; the name is also used loosely for the whole side-A/side-B package of the Riemann zeta.

Definition 4.4 (Weil explicit formula). For a test window $\hat{g}$ with transform g , $\sum_{\gamma} \hat{g}(\gamma) = \hat{g}(\frac{i}{2}) + \hat{g}(-\frac{i}{2}) - g(0) \log \pi + \frac{1}{2\pi} \int \hat{g}(r) \operatorname{Re}(\Gamma'/\Gamma)(\frac{1}{4} + \frac{ir}{2}) dr - 2 \sum_n \frac{\Lambda(n)}{\sqrt{n}} g(\log n)$, the sum on the left over the ordinates of the nontrivial zeros.

Definition 4.5 (Bost–Connes system, Lévy exponent). The *Bost–Connes system* is the C^* -dynamical system generated by the phase operators $e(a/b)$ and the isometries $\mathbf{m}_n$ on $\ell^2(\mathbb{N})$, with time evolution scaling $\mathbf{m}_n$ by n^{it} ; its $\operatorname{KMS}_{\beta}$ states for $\beta > 1$ have partition function $\zeta(\beta)$ and $\beta = 1$ is its phase transition. Its *Lévy exponent* at real part σ is $\kappa_{\sigma}(\tau) = \log \zeta(\sigma - i\tau) - \log \zeta(\sigma)$, the cumulant generating function of the zeta distribution, with jump measure ν_{σ} .

Definition 4.6 (Matrix product operator over the prime chain). Writing $\ell^2(\mathbb{N}) = \bigotimes_p$ (oscillator at p), an operator is a *matrix product operator over the prime chain* when it is a contraction of one local tensor per prime with a bond space carried between consecutive primes; for $e(a/b)$ the bond space is $\mathbb{Z}/b$ and the local transfer map is $r \mapsto p^k r$.

Definition 4.7 (Hilbert–Pólya operator). On the subleading sector of the length flow write $\mathcal{G} = -\frac{1}{2} + iH$; H is the *Hilbert–Pólya operator*, with eigenvalues $\gamma_n - i(\sigma_n - \frac{1}{2})$. It is not the entanglement Hamiltonian of any state.

Definition 4.8 (Weil positivity). *Weil’s criterion*: the Riemann hypothesis holds iff $F_W(u) = \sum_{\rho} e^{(\rho-1/2)u}$ is positive-definite on the dilation group, i.e. iff its spectral measure $\sum_{\rho} \delta_{t_{\rho}}$ is a positive measure on the real line.

4.2 Weil–LPS channels

Definition 4.9 (LPS generators). For a prime $q \equiv 1 \pmod{4}$, the *LPS generators* are the $q+1$ integer quaternions $\alpha = a_0 + a_1i + a_2j + a_3k$ of norm q with $a_0 > 0$ odd and a_1, a_2, a_3 even; they generate a $(q+1)$ -regular tree, and their images g_{α} in $\operatorname{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ (for q a square mod p , after division by s_q) are the generators of the LPS Cayley graph.

Definition 4.10 (Weil representation). The *Weil representation* W of $\operatorname{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ on $\ell^2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ is the projective unitary representation characterised by $W(g) T(u, v) W(g)^{\dagger} \propto T(g(u, v))$ for the Heisenberg–Weyl operators $T(u, v) = X^u Z^v$; it is generated by $\mathcal{F}$, $\mathbf{M}$ and $\mathbf{D}$ and splits into the blocks $W_{\pm}$ of dimensions $(p \pm 1)/2$ on which -1 acts as a scalar.

Definition 4.11 (Weil–LPS channel). For admissible $(p; q)$ the *Weil–LPS channel* is $\Phi_q^\pm(X) = \frac{1}{q+1} \sum_\alpha W_\pm(g_\alpha) X W_\pm(g_\alpha)^\dagger$ on $M_{(p\pm 1)/2}$: Harrow’s construction with the Weil representation and LPS generators.

Definition 4.12 (Hecke relation). The adjacency operators A_q of the LPS Cayley graph satisfy $A_q^2 - q1 = A_{q^2}$ and $A_{q_1}A_{q_2} = A_{q_1q_2}$, the tree relations “two steps without backtracking” and multiplicativity; the Weil–LPS channels for different q commute.

4.3 Curves

Definition 4.13 (Artin–Schreier curve, exponential sum). For $g \in \mathbb{F}_q[x]$ the *Artin–Schreier curve* is $y^q - y = g(x)$; its affine point count over $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ is $N_n = q^n + \sum_{a \in \mathbb{F}_q^\times} \mathcal{S}_n(ag)$ with the *exponential sum* $\mathcal{S}_n(g) = \sum_{x \in \mathbb{F}_{q^n}} e_q(\text{tr}_{q^n/q} g(x))$. The quadratic family is $g(x) = \sum_{j=0}^J a_j x^{1+q^j}$.

Definition 4.14 (Self-dual normal basis). A basis $\{\theta, \theta^q, \dots, \theta^{q^{n-1}}\}$ of $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ is *normal*; Frobenius is then the cyclic shift of coordinates. It is *self-dual* when $\text{tr}_{q^n/q}(ab) = \sum_i a_i b_i$; such bases exist for n odd.

Definition 4.15 (Dwork transfer operator). *Dwork’s operator* is $\mathcal{O}_{\text{Dw}} = \text{dec}_q \circ M_F$ on p -adic power series, multiplication by the splitting function M_F followed by the decimation $\text{dec}_q : x^m \mapsto x^{m/q}$; $\mathcal{S}_n^\times = (q^n - 1) \text{Tr } \mathcal{O}_{\text{Dw}}^n$ and L is its Fredholm determinant.

Definition 4.16 (Pure of weight, big monodromy, slicing, the sign). A coefficient system on a curve over $\mathbb{F}_q$ is *pure of weight* w when every eigenvalue of every holonomy of a prime cycle of length ℓ has modulus $q^{w\ell/2}$; it has *big monodromy* when the only invariants of its even tensor powers are the pairwise contractions by the given pairing. *Slicing* writes the middle block of a variety as the interesting block of a base curve with coefficients from hyperplane sections. *The sign* is the minus sign with which the interesting block enters the point count, so that its eigenvalues are zeros, not poles, of Z_C .

Definition 4.17 (Status vocabulary). The tags `proved`, `sketched`, `numerical`, `cited`, `conjectured`, `open`, `refuted`, `assumed`, with the derived forms `unsupported` and `-conditional`, as fixed in Section 2 of the frontmatter; definitions are `stipulated` or `quoted`.

4.4 The continuous dictionary

Definition 4.18 (Geodesic flow on the unit tangent bundle). For $\Gamma < \text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ discrete, torsion-free and cocompact, the unit tangent bundle of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ is $\Gamma \backslash G$ with $G = \text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{R})$, and the *geodesic flow* is $\phi_t(\Gamma g) = \Gamma g a_t$, $a_t = \text{diag}(e^{t/2}, e^{-t/2})$. Its generator is $\mathcal{X} = H/2$ through the left-invariant fields H, E, W of the basis H, E, W of $\mathfrak{sl}_2$, and the Koopman operator is $(e^{-t\mathcal{X}} f)(m) = f(\phi_{-t} m)$. Primitive closed geodesics γ have lengths ℓ_γ and opposite orientations are not identified.

Definition 4.19 (Selberg zeta, Ruelle zeta). $Z_{\text{Sel}}(s) = \prod_\gamma \prod_{k \geq 0} (1 - e^{-(s+k)\ell_\gamma})$, in Marklof’s words $Z(s) = \prod_{\{\gamma \in H_*\}} \prod_{m=0}^\infty (1 - e^{-(s+m)\ell_\gamma})$, (provenance `prov:marklof04-selbergzeta`), and the *Ruelle zeta* in the direct-product convention is $\zeta_R(s) = \prod_\gamma (1 - e^{-s\ell_\gamma})$.

Definition 4.20 (Guillemin flat trace). For an Anosov flow with closed orbits γ , primitive periods ℓ_γ and linearised Poincaré maps P_γ , the *flat trace* of the Koopman operator is the distribution on $t > 0$ $\text{Tr}^b e^{-t\mathcal{X}} = \sum_\gamma \sum_{k \geq 1} \ell_\gamma \delta(t - k\ell_\gamma) / |\det(1 - P_\gamma^k)|$ (Dyatlov–Zworski, provenance `prov:dz13-guillemin`). It is not a trace-class Hilbert-space trace.

Definition 4.21 (Flat dynamical determinant, first band). $A_{\text{fl}}(\varsigma) = \int_0^\infty e^{-\varsigma t} \text{Tr}^\flat e^{-t\mathcal{X}} dt$ for $\text{Re } \varsigma > 0$, and the *tower* $D_{\text{tow}}(\varsigma) = \prod_{j \geq 1} Z_{\text{Sel}}(\varsigma + j)$. *Trace resonances* are the poles of the continued A_{fl} . The *nonconstant first band* is $\mathcal{B}_0 = \{-\frac{1}{2} \pm ir_j : j \geq 1\}$, with $\lambda_j = \frac{1}{4} + r_j^2$ the Laplace eigenvalues and $r_0 = i/2$ for the constant mode excluded.

Definition 4.22 (Scattering determinant of the modular group). $\varphi(s) = \sqrt{\pi} \Gamma(s - \frac{1}{2}) \zeta(2s - 1) / (\Gamma(s) \zeta(2s))$, in the source's words In the case when Γ is the modular group $\text{PSL}(2, \mathbb{Z})$, the scattering determinant is given by $\phi(s) = \sqrt{\pi} \frac{\Gamma(s - 1/2)}{\Gamma(s)} \frac{\zeta(2s - 1)}{\zeta(2s)}$, (provenance prov:fjs16-scatt) the *scattering multiplier* is $m_{\text{sc}}(r) = -\frac{1}{2}(\varphi'/\varphi)(\frac{1}{2} + ir)$ and $C_{\text{cusp}} = \mathcal{F}^{-1} m_{\text{sc}}$ with $\mathcal{F}^{-1} b(t) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int e^{irt} b(r) dr$.

Definition 4.23 (Prime comb measures). $P_+(t) = \sum_{n \geq 2} \frac{\Lambda(n)}{n} \delta(t - 2 \log n)$ and $P_{\text{ch}}(t) = \sum_{n \geq 2} \Lambda(n) n^{-1/2} \delta(t - 2 \log n)$ on $(0, \infty)$, locally finite measures; A_{arch} is the archimedean-plus-boundary distribution of Proposition 13.5, equal to $\frac{1}{2} - 1/(4 \sinh(|t|/2))$ away from $t = 0$.

5 What the Riemann Hypothesis Has Become

Nothing here is new mathematics; it is a translation, written for TJO after the founding session from the ingredients built up there. Its point is one sentence, isolated in observation 5.3 and repeated in every later costume: the Riemann hypothesis says certain counts fluctuate no more than a random sequence would.

5.1 The one identity, and its two readings

Observation 5.1 (The one identity). [sketched] For any matrix M with eigenvalues $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_N$,

$$\frac{1}{\det(1 - uM)} = \prod_i \frac{1}{1 - \lambda_i u} = \exp\left(\sum_{\ell \geq 1} \frac{\text{Tr}(M^\ell)}{\ell} u^\ell\right).$$

The middle expression is a bosonic partition function, one mode per eigenvector with Boltzmann factor $\lambda_i u$; the right expression is a sum over closed walks of length ℓ , carrying the $1/\ell$ of a ring's rotation symmetry. One object, two descriptions: a gas of modes and a gas of rings (Definitions 3.1 and 3.2).

The whole subject is the tension between the two sides. For a permutation matrix the ring side is concrete: $\text{Tr}(M^\ell)$ counts the fixed points of the ℓ -th power, the closed walks are the cycles and their repeats, and the identity collapses to $\det(1 - uM)^{-1} = \prod_c (1 - u^{|c|})^{-1}$ over cycles c : a Bose gas with one mode per cycle, energy the cycle length. That product is the Euler product, and the primes will be the cycles.

5.2 A finite permutation: the analogue is free

Observation 5.2 (RH for a finite permutation). [sketched]
A permutation matrix permutes an orthonormal basis, hence is unitary, hence has every eigenvalue on the unit circle. The RH analogue at this level costs nothing.

5.3 An infinite permutation: a statement about a different matrix

For infinitely many cycles the permutation matrix is still unitary and still useless, its spectrum being roots of unity with infinite multiplicity. The count $\text{fix}(\ell) = \sum_{d|\ell} d c_d$ of fixed points of the ℓ -th power, with c_d the number of d -cycles, remains meaningful, and the interesting object is a *small matrix* (Definition 3.3) reproducing them.

Observation 5.3 (RH for the small matrix). [sketched] A small matrix M_{small} with $\text{Tr } M_{\text{small}}^\ell = \text{fix}(\ell)$ for all ℓ exists exactly when the zeta function is rational, and then its eigenvalues are new numbers, off the unit circle. Writing $\text{fix}(\ell) = \lambda_{\text{max}}^\ell + \sum_{i \geq 2} \lambda_i^\ell$, the RH analogue is that every other nonzero λ_i has $|\lambda_i| = \sqrt{\lambda_{\text{max}}}$ (Definition 3.4), so that the fluctuation has size $\sqrt{\lambda_{\text{max}}^\ell}$: the square root of the leading term, which is the fluctuation of a sum of $\lambda_{\text{max}}^\ell$ independent coin tosses. In counting language, RH says the cycle counts fluctuate no more than a random sequence would.

So the RH analogue is here a property some systems have and others do not. The note records two shift examples, both perfectly good infinite permutations.

shift	eigenvalues of the small matrix	RH analogue
4-symbol cyclic rule	2, $1 + i$, $1 - i$, 0	holds
golden-mean shift	ϕ , $-1/\phi$	fails

5.4 A graph: Ramanujan

Observation 5.4 (RH for a graph is the Ramanujan property). [sketched]

For a $(q+1)$ -regular graph the permutation is the shift on non-backtracking closed walks, the small matrix is the adjacency matrix A , and the Ihara–Bass formula (Definition 3.8) compresses one to the other: each eigenvalue λ of A produces a pair μ, μ' of eigenvalues of the edge operator T through

$$\mu^2 - \lambda\mu + q = 0, \quad \text{so} \quad \mu\mu' = q.$$

The leading $\lambda = q+1$ gives $\mu = q, \mu' = 1$. For the rest, $\lambda^2 < 4q$ forces a complex conjugate pair with $|\mu| = |\mu'| = \sqrt{q}$, on the critical circle, while $\lambda^2 > 4q$ gives a real pair, one factor above $\sqrt{q}$ and one below. Hence RH for ζ_X holds if and only if $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$ for every nontrivial λ , i.e. iff the graph is Ramanujan (Definition 3.9), and the closed non-backtracking walk counts are $N_\ell = q^\ell + O(q^{\ell/2})$.

Three remarks carry over to the primes. First, **the pairing comes from a symmetry, the hypothesis from a bound**: $\mu\mu' = q$ is a functional equation pairing eigenvalues symmetrically about $\sqrt{q}$ on a logarithmic scale, and RH is the extra statement that each pair is degenerate in modulus, which happens exactly when it is a conjugate pair. Second, **self-adjointness is not enough**: A is symmetric, so λ is real, which guarantees the pairing but not the bound; the prism graph $C_{16} \times K_2$ is symmetric and fails it. Third, **the bound is geometric**: $[-2\sqrt{q}, 2\sqrt{q}]$ is the spectrum of the infinite tree covering the graph, so RH says the graph has no eigenvalue outside the spectrum of its universal cover; the word is tempered.

5.5 A matrix product state: one correlation length

Let $E = \Sigma$ be the transfer matrix of a matrix product state (Definition 3.12), so that $\text{Tr } E^n = \langle \Psi_n | \Psi_n \rangle$ is the ring norm of the periodic state on n sites (Definition 3.13) and the zeta function of observation 5.1 is the generating function of ring norms. In canonical form (Definition 3.14) the leading eigenvalue is 1 and the rest lie inside the unit disc, $\lambda_k = e^{-1/\ell_k^c + i\vartheta_k}$ (Definition 3.15), so $\langle \Psi_n | \Psi_n \rangle = 1 + \sum_k e^{-n/\ell_k^c} e^{in\vartheta_k}$.

Observation 5.5 (RH for an MPS). [sketched] Translating observation 5.4, where the leading growth is q per step and the subleading modulus $\sqrt{q}$: in normalised units the subleading modulus is $q^{-1/2}$, so $e^{-1/\ell_k^c} = q^{-1/2}$ and $\ell_k^c = 2/\log q = 2/h$ for every k . The RH analogue for an MPS reads: all correlation lengths are equal, and equal to twice the inverse entropy rate. The phases ϑ_k are unconstrained and there may be infinitely many of them; only the moduli are pinned.

The hierarchy this sits in has three levels, and each has a classical number-theoretic counterpart, anticipating observation 5.6 below.

statement about E (or $\mathcal{G}$)	name	counting meaning	number theory
a unique eigenvalue on the unit circle	primitivity (Perron–Frobenius)	ring norms follow the leading term	$\zeta(1+it) \neq 0$, the prime number theorem
all others inside a smaller circle	spectral gap	fluctuation exponentially smaller than the leading term	the zero-free region, $\psi(x) = x + O(xe^{-c\sqrt{\log x}})$
all others on one circle of radius e^{-1/ℓ_k^c} with $\ell_k^c = 2/h$	Ramanujan / RH	fluctuation is the square root of the leading term	all zeros on $\text{Re } s = \frac{1}{2}$

5.6 The primes: continuous length, and the sign

For the primes the cycle lengths are $\log p$, rationally independent, so the matrix powers become a semigroup $e^{\mathbf{L}\mathcal{G}}$ in a continuous length $\mathbf{L}$ and the ring norms become a measure in $\mathbf{L}$. Start from the Riemann–von Mangoldt formula for ψ , valid for x not a prime power, put $x = e^{\mathbf{L}}$ and differentiate in $\mathbf{L}$: the left side becomes a sum of delta functions, one per prime power, of weight $\log p$, and the right side a sum of exponentials.

Observation 5.6 (The explicit formula as a trace, and the pairing). [sketched] With $\psi(x) = x - \sum_{\rho} x^{\rho} / \rho - \log 2\pi - \frac{1}{2} \log(1 - x^{-2})$,

$$\sum_n \Lambda(n) \delta(\mathbf{L} - \log n) = e^{\mathbf{L}} - \sum_{\rho} e^{\rho \mathbf{L}} = (e^{-2\mathbf{L}} + e^{-4\mathbf{L}} + \dots),$$

which is $\text{Tr } e^{\mathbf{L}\mathcal{G}}$ for a generator $\mathcal{G}$ whose eigenvalues are 1 (the pole of ζ , the leading term, entropy 1), every zero ρ , and the trivial zeros $-2, -4, \dots$: the trace identity of observation 5.1 with M^{ℓ} replaced by $e^{\mathbf{L}\mathcal{G}}$, ring side the prime powers at lengths $\log n$, mode side the zeros. The functional equation $\xi(s) = \xi(1-s)$ makes ρ and $1-\rho$ both zeros, so after dividing by the leading $e^{\mathbf{L}}$ the normalised decay rates come in pairs $(1-\sigma, \sigma)$ summing to 1, exactly as $\mu\mu' = q$ paired the graph eigenvalues around $\sqrt{q}$. That pairing is a theorem; RH is the extra statement that every pair is degenerate, $\sigma = 1 - \sigma = \frac{1}{2}$.

Two features of this trace identity are visible immediately. The first is *the sign*: the zeros enter with a minus sign relative to the leading term, the same minus sign that marks the fermionic H^1 block in the elliptic-curve case (Section 9) and the absorption spectrum in Connes’s language. The total measure stays positive because $\Lambda(n) \geq 0$, but the subleading sector of the bond space contributes negatively, so whatever state this is, its bond space is graded, not plainly bosonic. The second is the pairing just stated. The numerical check against several thousand zeros is recorded in Section 6. Collecting the costumes:

language	the Riemann hypothesis says
counting	$\psi(x) = x + O(x^{1/2+\epsilon})$: the prime powers fluctuate like coin tosses
small matrix	every subleading mode has modulus the square root of the leading one
MPS	the state whose rings are the primes has <i>one</i> correlation length, $\ell_k^c = 2$ since $h = 1$, and an infinite tower of frequencies γ_n
channel	the transfer semigroup $e^{\mathbf{L}\mathcal{G}}$ has a single uniform decay rate $\frac{1}{2}$

5.7 The Hilbert space where this is literally true

The channel version is not only an analogy. It is a theorem on a concrete Hilbert space: the model space K_S of the scattering symbol S of the modular surface, on which the compressed dilation semigroup $Z(t)$ has one mode per zero, with decay rate and frequency read off from that zero. This is Lax–Phillips [26], and “RH iff every mode of $Z(t)$ decays at the same rate” is Faddeev–Pavlov [13]. What the founding session added is where S comes from: its phase is the imaginary part of the Bost–Connes Lévy exponent at the critical temperature $\beta = 1$ [6], so the ring gas and the transfer semigroup are one object seen from its two ends, bridged by the critical phase. Construction, normalisations (the factor $\frac{1}{2}$ from the doubled variable) and numerics are in Section 6; Definitions 4.1 to 4.3 fix the objects.

5.8 Why it is still hard, in this language

The graph case is the honest guide. There side B exists, the trace identity holds and the small matrix is symmetric for every graph, and most graphs fail the bound. Being Ramanujan is never a consequence of the structure; it is an extra fact, and in every known case it comes from arithmetic input of Deligne's type [7]. For Selberg's surfaces the same statement, no Laplace eigenvalue below $\frac{1}{4}$, is open.

What the translation settles: RH is a statement about the *sizes* of the subleading modes of a transfer semigroup, not about its existence. The semigroup exists, the zeros are its modes, the primes are its rings, the functional equation is the pairing of its rates. What it does not settle: a mechanism forcing the pairs to be degenerate. In positivity form (Definition 4.8), RH holds iff F_W is positive-definite on the dilation group, iff its spectral measure is positive on the real line, which by Bochner is the same as all its atoms being real.

Observation 5.7 (Hermiticity of the Hilbert–Pólya operator).

[sketched]

Write the length-flow generator on the subleading sector as $\mathcal{G} = -\frac{1}{2} + iH$ (Definition 4.7); then H has eigenvalues $\gamma_n - i(\sigma_n - \frac{1}{2})$, and RH says exactly that H is Hermitian, i.e. that the transfer semigroup is a uniform damping times an oscillation with real frequencies. H is the Hilbert–Pólya operator. The non-Hermitian generator carries the complex pairs and the Hermitian operator their symmetric combination, here $\rho(1 - \rho) = \sigma(1 - \sigma) + \gamma^2 + i\gamma(1 - 2\sigma)$, which is real iff $\sigma = \frac{1}{2}$; $\mathcal{G}$ is to H what the Hashimoto edge operator T is to the adjacency matrix A of a graph. For graphs the Hermitian object is given and its reality is a theorem; for the primes it is the conjecture.

Proving it would mean exhibiting that state, or a Stinespring form of $Z(t)$ with the prime dilations as Kraus operators, in a way that makes the positivity manifest; that is conjecture 6.9. The graph lesson says the Kraus structure alone will not do it, and that some arithmetic rigidity has to enter, playing the role that weights play for curves (Section 9).

5.9 Erratum on words

An earlier draft, and the founding session, called $-\log E$ the entanglement Hamiltonian. That is wrong: the entanglement Hamiltonian of an MPS is $-\log$ of a reduced density matrix built from the fixed points of E alone, is Hermitian by construction, and does not see the subleading spectrum. The operator whose spectrum contains the zeros is the transfer generator, non-Hermitian in general, whose eigenvalue phases are the oscillation frequencies of the ring norms. observation 5.7 states the correct relation; the route is listed among the dead ones in Section 14.

5.10 Summary

A zeta function is one partition function with two Fock-space descriptions: a gas of rings (cycles, closed walks, prime powers) and a gas of modes (eigenvalues of a small transfer matrix); the trace identity links them. For the primes the rings have lengths $\log n$ and weights $\Lambda(n)$, the modes are the zeros of ζ plus the pole, and the functional equation pairs the modes' decay rates as $(\sigma, 1 - \sigma)$. The Riemann hypothesis says every pair is degenerate at $\frac{1}{2}$: the transfer semigroup has one correlation length, $\ell_k^c = 2$, so the ring counts fluctuate by no more than the square root of their size, so the primes are as regular as coin tosses. That semigroup exists explicitly, its scattering symbol is the phase of the Bost–Connes system at its critical temperature, and RH is the statement that this channel is Ramanujan.

6 The Riemann Channel: Bost–Connes at Critical Temperature, Compressed

This section is the lab-book version of `notes/riemann-channel-note.md`, a scratch note of the founding session. It assembles one object out of three standard pieces: Lax–Phillips scattering on the modular surface, the Sz.-Nagy–Foias functional model of an inner function, and the Bost–Connes system at its phase transition. Nothing here is new mathematics; the content is the identification of the three, and the numerical checks that it is stated correctly. Everything below is *equivalent to*, never a proof of, the Riemann hypothesis. Several statements are theorem-level standard theory (Faddeev–Pavlov, Lax–Phillips, Adamyan–Arov, Khinchin) for which this repo holds no local source and no written-out argument; they carry the tag `sketched` for that reason, not because their truth is in doubt.

6.1 Setting

Let τ be the Mellin variable on the dilation group $\mathbb{R}_+^\times$, so that dilation by e^t acts on $L^2(\mathbb{R}_+^\times)$ as the multiplier $e^{it\tau}$. With the completed zeta

$$\xi(s) = \frac{1}{2} s(s-1) \pi^{-s/2} \Gamma(s/2) \zeta(s),$$

the scattering symbol of the modular surface in this variable (Definition 4.1) is

$$S(\tau) = \frac{\xi(1-2i\tau)}{\xi(1+2i\tau)}.$$

Write a nontrivial zero as $\rho_n = \sigma_n + i\gamma_n$, so that the Riemann hypothesis is $\sigma_n = \frac{1}{2}$ for all n (Section 2).

6.2 The symbol is inner

Proposition 6.1 (The scattering symbol is inner, with the zeros as its zeros). *[sketched]* *S is unimodular on the real line, analytic and contractive in the lower half plane $\text{Im } \tau < 0$, and its zeros there are exactly*

$$\tau_n = \frac{\gamma_n}{2} - i \frac{\sigma_n}{2}, \quad \rho_n = \sigma_n + i\gamma_n \text{ a nontrivial zero of } \zeta.$$

The note’s argument: ξ is real on the real axis and satisfies $\xi(s) = \xi(1-s)$, which gives $|S| = 1$ for real τ ; for $\text{Im } \tau < 0$ the denominator’s argument $1+2i\tau$ has real part greater than 1, inside the Euler product, so S is analytic there. Contractivity in the interior is the Phragmén–Lindelöf step, which the note does not write out (step 3 of `HANDOFF.md`); for the modular surface it is classical [13, 26]. The zeros are a substitution: $\xi(1-2i\tau) = 0$ iff $1-2i\tau$ is a nontrivial zero.

6.3 The compressed semigroup

Since S is inner, the model space $K_S = H^2 \ominus SH^2$ (Definition 4.2) carries the compressed dilation semigroup $Z(t) = P_{K_S} e^{it\tau}|_{K_S}$, $t > 0$. By Adamyan–Arov this is unitarily equivalent to the Lax–Phillips semigroup of the modular surface with the cusp forms removed; the note states this without a written argument, and no local source exists for it here.

Proposition 6.2 (One mode per zero; RH as a single decay rate).

[sketched]

For each zero λ of S in the lower half plane the reproducing kernel $k_\lambda(\tau) = (\tau - \bar{\lambda})^{-1}$ lies in K_S , and $Z(t)^* k_\lambda = e^{-it\bar{\lambda}} k_\lambda$. With $\lambda = \gamma_n/2 - i\sigma_n/2$ the eigenvalue is $\exp(-\sigma_n t/2 - i\gamma_n t/2)$: one mode per zero, decay rate $\sigma_n/2$, frequency $\gamma_n/2$. Hence the Riemann hypothesis holds if and only if every mode of $Z(t)$ decays at the single rate $1/4$.

The kernel is orthogonal to SH^2 precisely because $S(\lambda) = 0$. The last sentence is the Faddeev–Pavlov / Lax–Phillips reading of RH [13, 26]; it is the “one correlation length” criterion of Section 5 (observation 5.5) on an explicit Hilbert space, with K_S in the role of the bond space. The completely positive lift is immediate and uninformative: $\Phi_t(X) = Z(t)^* X Z(t)$ on $B(K_S)$ is the Riemann channel of Definition 4.3, a sub-unital semigroup with one Kraus operator, whose Stinespring dilation is the automorphic wave group and whose environment is the pair of incoming and outgoing subspaces, that is, the cusp. Whether a less trivial Kraus decomposition exists is conjecture 6.9.

6.4 Where the primes are

Two placements of the primes appear, and the note is explicit that they are different objects. The first is a dilation-covariant Markov semigroup on $L^2(\mathbb{R}_+^\times)$ in Holevo form, with the von Mangoldt jump measure $\nu_\sigma = \sum_{p,k} \frac{p^{-k\sigma}}{k} \delta_{k \log p}$ and symbol

$$\left(\frac{\zeta(\sigma - i\tau)}{\zeta(\sigma)} \right)^t = \exp \left(t \sum_{p,k} \frac{p^{-k\sigma}}{k} (e^{ik\tau \log p} - 1) \right),$$

a genuine Markov semigroup for $\sigma > 1$ by Khinchin’s theorem that the zeta distribution is compound Poisson (standard; no local source). It has no zeros for $\sigma > 1$, and at $\sigma = \frac{1}{2}$ it is not a semigroup at all, the symbol being unbounded. The Bost–Connes phase transition $\beta = 1$ is the finite- versus infinite-activity threshold of ν_σ [6].

The second is $Z(t)$ on K_S : the zeros as resonances, no jump structure, the primes entering only through S . The bridge between the two is the boundary phase.

Proposition 6.3 (The symbol is the phase of the critical Lévy exponent). [sketched] For real τ , $S(\tau) = \exp(-2i \arg \xi(1 + 2i\tau))$, and

$$-\arg \zeta(1 + 2i\tau) = \sum_p \sum_{k \geq 1} \frac{p^{-k}}{k} \sin(2k\tau \log p),$$

which is the imaginary part of the Bost–Connes Lévy exponent $\kappa_\sigma(\tau') = \log \zeta(\sigma - i\tau') - \log \zeta(\sigma)$ at the critical temperature $\sigma = 1$, $\tau' = 2\tau$. Hence S is the phase of the critical Lévy exponent times the Gamma phase.

The real part of κ_1 diverges, since $\sum_p p^{-1} = \infty$; that divergence is the Bost–Connes phase transition. The imaginary part converges conditionally, at prime-number-theorem strength, i.e. by $\zeta(1 + it) \neq 0$. The bridge the note proposes: take the Bost–Connes process at $\beta = 1$, discard the divergent real part of its Lévy exponent, keep the phase, and use that unimodular function as the characteristic function of a contraction semigroup. Symbolically, Lax–Phillips = (Bost–Connes at $\beta = 1$) + (Sz.-Nagy–Foias), at the level of boundary phases.

6.5 Numerical check of the symbol

Numerical result 6.4 (Unimodularity, zeros, innerness and the prime phase). [numerical]
`scripts/scat.py` (`outputs/scat.txt`, mpmath at 20 digits) reports $||S| - 1| = 0$ to machine precision at $\tau = 0.3, 2.0, 7.5, 21.3$; a root search from $\gamma_n/2 - \frac{1}{4}i$ converging for $n = 1, \dots, 6$ to $\gamma_n/2 - 0.250000i$ with $|S| \leq 1.5 \cdot 10^{-20}$; $|S| = 0.9348, 0.5393, 0.8344, 0.2718$ at the interior points $\tau = 3 - 0.6i, 10 - i, 0.5 - 2i, 30 - 0.3i$; and Proposition 6.3 to $1.3 \cdot 10^{-3}$ or better at five points:

τ	exact	prime sum + tail	residual
0.7	+0.80572	+0.80469	$-1.0 \cdot 10^{-3}$
1.9	-0.03879	-0.03854	$+2.5 \cdot 10^{-4}$
4.2	-0.17233	-0.17306	$-7.3 \cdot 10^{-4}$
9.0	+0.06468	+0.06594	$+1.3 \cdot 10^{-3}$
15.5	-0.06432	-0.06409	$+2.3 \cdot 10^{-4}$

The middle column is the prime sum over $p < 3 \cdot 10^6$ truncated at $k \leq 6$ plus the prime-number-theorem tail $\pi/2 - \text{Si}(2\tau \log X)$, which is what makes the residual 10^{-3} rather than 10^{-2} ; `outputs/scat.txt` archives the bare prime sums, before the tail, at three of the five points (0.82380, -0.05607, -0.18043). The innerness numbers are a check at four points, not a proof.

6.6 Ring norms: the trace of the semigroup is the prime measure

Distributionally $\text{Tr } Z(t) = \sum_n e^{-t\sigma_n/2 + it\gamma_n/2}$, under RH $e^{-t/4} \sum_n e^{it\gamma_n/2}$. The Weil explicit formula (Definition 4.4) turns that zero sum into a prime sum: in the ring-length variable $L = t/2$, with window $\hat{g}$ and transform g ,

$$\sum_{\gamma} \hat{g}(\gamma) = \hat{g}\left(\frac{i}{2}\right) + \hat{g}\left(-\frac{i}{2}\right) - g(0) \log \pi + \frac{1}{2\pi} \int \hat{g}(r) \text{Re}(\Gamma'/\Gamma)\left(\frac{1}{4} + \frac{ir}{2}\right) dr - 2 \sum_n \frac{\Lambda(n)}{\sqrt{n}} g(\log n).$$

Proposition 6.5 (The primes are the ring spectrum of the Riemann channel). [sketched] *The distributional trace of $Z(t)$ is supported at the ring lengths $t = 2 \log n$ with weight $\Lambda(n) n^{-1/2}$.*

After the $e^{-t/4} = n^{-1/2}$ decay of the modes this is the $\sigma = 1$ Lévy measure ν_1 weighted by jump length, $\Lambda(n)/n$. In the MPS dictionary of Section 5: rings of length $\log n$ with weight $\Lambda(n)$, a transfer generator with eigenvalues $-\frac{1}{2} \pm i\gamma_n$, and a single correlation length iff RH. The primes are the ring spectrum, the zeros the transfer spectrum, and one identity, the explicit formula, links them (Definition 3.2).

Numerical result 6.6 (Windowed zero sum against the full explicit formula). [numerical]
`scripts/ringnorm.py` (`outputs/ringnorm.txt`) sums the first 3000 zeros ($\gamma_{\max} = 3533.3$) against the Gaussian window $\hat{g}(r) = \cos(rL)e^{-r^2/2G_w^2}$ with $G_w = 1009.5$, for which the truncation weight at $\gamma_{\max}$ is $2.2 \cdot 10^{-3}$. The numeric side is $F(L) = \sum_{\gamma > 0} e^{-\gamma^2/2G_w^2} \cos(\gamma L)$ on $L \in [0.3, 3.3]$; the prediction is every term of the explicit formula above, archimedean digamma integral included. The prime terms are Gaussian dips of depth $\frac{G_w}{2\sqrt{2\pi}} \Lambda(n) n^{-1/2}$ at $L = \log n$:

n	$\log n$	$F(\mathbb{L}_n)$	prediction	ratio	$\Lambda(n)/\sqrt{n}$
2	0.6931	-97.95	-98.13	0.998	0.490
3	1.0986	-126.83	-127.02	0.999	0.634
4	1.3863	-68.77	-68.94	0.998	0.347
5	1.6094	-143.66	-143.86	0.999	0.720
7	1.9459	-146.71	-146.92	0.999	0.736
8	2.0794	-47.87	-48.03	0.997	0.245
9	2.1972	-72.19	-72.36	0.998	0.366
11	2.3979	-143.86	-144.07	0.999	0.723
13	2.5649	-141.21	-141.41	0.999	0.711
16	2.7726	-32.88	-33.03	0.995	0.173
27	3.2958	-39.93	-40.09	0.996	0.211

The maximum of $|F - \text{prediction}|$ over the whole interval is 0.20, against dip depths up to 147; away from the dips it is 0.18, so the residual is flat and is the truncation of the zero sum, not a mismatch of terms. Depths scale as $\Lambda(n)/\sqrt{n}$, prime powers included. The archived output carries four further rows ($n = 17, 19, 23, 25$) with the same ratios; the table above is the note's selection.

6.7 The Bost–Connes phase operators as an MPO over the prime chain

Item 2 of `HANDOFF.md` concerns the Bost–Connes system itself rather than its compression. Its Hilbert space factorises over the primes, one oscillator per prime (Definition 4.6); the Gibbs state at inverse temperature β is a product state with local weight $(1 - p^{-\beta})p^{-\beta k}$ at occupation k , and the isometries m_n act locally.

Proposition 6.7 (The Bost–Connes phase operator is a prime-chain MPO). *[sketched]*
The Bost–Connes phase operator $e(a/b)$ is a matrix product operator over the prime chain with bond space $\mathbb{Z}/b$, the local transfer map being $r \mapsto p^k r$, that is, Shor's map U_{p^k} at the site p . In the Dirichlet character basis the transfer eigenvalues are $L(\beta, \bar{\chi})/\zeta(\beta)$.

Extremal KMS_β states differ only by the boundary residue of the chain, and $\beta \rightarrow 1^+$ kills every nontrivial character sector: the symmetry breaking of [6] read as a boundary effect. Shor's unitary U_a is the level- N Galois symmetry of the system and a snapshot of the dilation flow.

Numerical result 6.8 (MPO contraction against Hurwitz zeta and Dirichlet L -values). *[numerical]*
`scripts/bcmpo.py` (`outputs/bcmpo.txt`) contracts the chain over all primes below $2 \cdot 10^5$ (occupations $k \leq 60$) and compares with the Hurwitz-zeta closed form $\zeta(\beta)^{-1} b^{-\beta} \sum_r e^{2\pi i ar/b} \zeta(\beta, r/b)$:

$a/b, \beta$	MPO	closed form	diff
1/3, 2.0	$-0.333333 + 0.411340i$	$-0.333333 + 0.411340i$	$1.6 \cdot 10^{-7}$
1/4, 2.0	$-0.125000 + 0.556841i$	$-0.125000 + 0.556840i$	$2.1 \cdot 10^{-7}$
2/5, 1.5	$-0.263990 + 0.143625i$	$-0.263949 + 0.143579i$	$6.1 \cdot 10^{-5}$
1/6, 1.7	$+0.103130 + 0.502210i$	$+0.103130 + 0.502200i$	$1.0 \cdot 10^{-5}$

For $b = 5$, $\beta = 1.5$ the contracted transfer operator on the units is diagonal in the character basis to a spread of $2.6 \cdot 10^{-14}$, with eigenvalues $0.910557, 0.354022 \mp 0.067781i, 0.225025$ against `mpmath` $L(\beta, \chi)/\zeta(\beta)$ values $0.910557, 0.353909 \pm 0.067760i, 0.224953$: agreement to $1.1 \cdot 10^{-4}$, with the expected conjugation between the two lists.

The residuals are the truncation of the Euler product at $2 \cdot 10^5$ and grow as β approaches 1, as they must. The relevance here is structural: the bond space of the phase operators is $\mathbb{Z}/b$, finite and abelian, whereas that of the compressed semigroup is K_S , and the note offers no map between them.

6.8 What is not established

RH itself is not touched; every statement above is an equivalent form of the uniform-rate statement. The innerness argument is not written out (Proposition 6.1), the Adamyan–Arov identification is quoted without a local source, and the bridge is a statement about boundary phases, not about the operators. No identification with the $\beta > 1$ constructions of the parent repository is claimed: those sit above the phase transition, the object here is the $\beta = 1$ phase compressed to a co-invariant subspace.

Conjecture 6.9 (Stinespring form with prime jumps). *[open] There is a Stinespring form of the compressed semigroup $Z(t)$ on K_S whose Kraus (jump) operators are the prime dilations.*

The single-Kraus lift exists trivially and says nothing; the Holevo-form covariant Lindbladian with jump measure ν_σ lives on the full regular representation and is not the compressed object. Whether a jump-type generator on K_S reproduces $Z(t)$ is the open question this note isolates, and its physical index would be the Stinespring environment. A negative answer with a reason is a result; the route is listed in Section 14.

7 Weil–LPS Channels: Exactly Ramanujan Quantum Expanders

This is the finite model of the Riemann channel of Section 6 with every ingredient present and every claim checkable: commuting dilations indexed by primes, an arithmetic quotient supplying the expansion, and the Weil representation as the Hilbert space. The construction was proposed in the founding session’s handoff and computed on 2026-09-11; everything below was computed, and every construction step carries its own numerical check. The object itself is Definition 4.11, its ingredients Definition 4.9 and Definition 4.10.

7.1 The object

Fix an odd prime p and an LPS parameter $q \equiv 1 \pmod{4}$ with q a square mod p . The Weil intertwiner exists only for symplectic (determinant one) matrices, and q being a square is what lets the norm- q quaternions land in $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ after scaling. The admissible pairs computed are these.

p	q	$ \mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p) $	Weil blocks $M_{(p+1)/2}, M_{(p-1)/2}$
5	29	60	M_3, M_2
7	29	168	M_4, M_3
11	5	660	M_6, M_5
13	17, 29	1092	M_7, M_6
17	13	2448	M_9, M_8
19	5, 17	3420	M_{10}, M_9
29	5, 13	12180	M_{15}, M_{14}

Step 1, generators. The $q+1$ integer quaternions $\alpha = a_0 + a_1i + a_2j + a_3k$ of norm q with $a_0 > 0$ odd and a_1, a_2, a_3 even. Jacobi’s four-square theorem gives exactly $q+1$ of them; the enumeration was checked against the divisor sum $\sum_{d|n} d$ for the norms q, q^2 and q_1q_2 used below. The same $p=5$ quaternions appear in Appendix C of [21].

Step 2, images in $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$. Split the Hamilton quaternions over $\mathbb{F}_p$ by

$$\mathbf{I} = \begin{pmatrix} x & y \\ y & -x \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{J} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad x^2 + y^2 + 1 \equiv 0 \pmod{p}.$$

Then $\alpha \mapsto a_0 + a_1\mathbf{I} + a_2\mathbf{J} + a_3\mathbf{IJ}$ is a ring homomorphism whose determinant is the quaternion norm. Dividing by a square root s_q of $q \bmod p$ gives $g_\alpha \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$. Checked: $\det g_\alpha = 1$, $g_{\bar{\alpha}} = g_\alpha^{-1}$, and all $q+1$ images distinct.

Step 3, the Weil representation, built and checked numerically. On $\ell^2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ take the clock and shift operators Z, X and the Heisenberg–Weyl operators $T(u, v) = X^u Z^v$. The Fourier transform $\mathcal{F}$, the chirp M and a dilation D each satisfy an intertwining relation of the form

$$W(g) T(u, v) W(g)^\dagger \propto T(g(u, v)),$$

with a symplectic g that the code *reads off* rather than assumes. A breadth-first search over $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ in these three generators assigns a unitary $W(g)$ to every group element, projectively; for $p=13$ the table has the expected $p(p^2-1) = 2184$ entries. The relation above was then verified directly for each LPS generator g_α , with error at most $4 \cdot 10^{-14}$ in every case ($7.2 \cdot 10^{-15}$ for $(p, q) = (13, 17)$, $7.0 \cdot 10^{-15}$ for $(13, 29)$). Since only $\mathrm{Ad} W$ enters the channel, the projective phases are irrelevant.

Step 4, the two irreducible blocks. $W(-1)$ is the parity operator, so W splits into even and odd functions, of dimensions $(p \pm 1)/2$. Each block $W_{\pm}$ is irreducible and -1 acts on it as a scalar, so it is a representation of $\text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ up to phase. This matters: on the full M_p the parity operator would be a second fixed point of the channel, and Harrow’s theorem needs irreducibility. The channels are

$$\Phi_q^{\pm}(X) = \frac{1}{q+1} \sum_{\alpha} W_{\pm}(g_{\alpha}) X W_{\pm}(g_{\alpha})^{\dagger} \quad \text{on } M_{(p \pm 1)/2},$$

that is, $D = q + 1$ unitary Kraus operators in the normalisation of Section 2. Block unitarity and Hilbert–Schmidt self-adjointness of the superoperator were checked at 10^{-14} (for (13, 17): deviations $2.7 \cdot 10^{-15}$ and $1.8 \cdot 10^{-15}$).

7.2 Exact Ramanujan behaviour

Proposition 7.1 (Weil–LPS channels are exactly Ramanujan). *[sketched]* For every admissible pair $(p; q)$, each block channel $\Phi_q^{\pm}$ is a Ramanujan quantum expander in the sense of Definition 3.17: $\lambda_2(\Phi_q^{\pm}) \leq \lambda_H$, equivalently $(q+1)\lambda_2 \leq 2\sqrt{q}$ in adjacency units.

The argument is two lines. Harrow’s transfer inequality (cited fact 11.5, [17]) says that for the channel built from an irreducible representation of a group and a symmetric generating set, the second singular value of the channel is at most the second singular value of the transition matrix of the Cayley graph on that generating set. Here the group is $\text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$, the generating set is the $q+1$ images g_{α} of Definition 4.9, and the representation is $W_{\pm}$, irreducible by Step 4; so $(q+1)\lambda_2(\Phi_q^{\pm})$ is bounded by the largest modulus of a nontrivial eigenvalue of the LPS Cayley graph A_q . That graph is Ramanujan, $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$, by Lubotzky, Phillips and Sarnak [27], and $2\sqrt{q} = 2\sqrt{D-1}$ is exactly Hastings’ bound λ_H in adjacency units [19]. The status is **sketched** rather than **proved** because the Lubotzky–Phillips–Sarnak theorem has no byte-verified local source in **refs/**, and because the irreducibility of $W_{\pm}$ and the projective-phase bookkeeping of Step 4 are verified numerically here rather than cited. Iyer, Jain, Jordan and Somma [21] state the $\text{SU}(2)$ version of the same mechanism and call explicit Ramanujan quantum expanders a longstanding open problem; see Section 11.

Numerical result 7.2 (Ramanujan, Harrow containment, Hecke, commutation). **[numerical]**
For $(p; q)$ in $\{(5; 29), (7; 29), (11; 5), (13; 17, 29), (17; 13), (19; 5, 17), (29; 5, 13)\}$ the channels $\Phi_q^{\pm}$ on the even and odd Weil blocks satisfy the Ramanujan bound of Definition 3.17 and have a unique fixed point; Harrow containment, the Hecke relation of Definition 4.12 and commutation across q hold to 10^{-14} .

Every entry of the table below is on the correct side of the bound $2\sqrt{q}$, in adjacency units.

p	q	Cayley A_q		Φ_q^{+}		Φ_q^{-}		$2\sqrt{q}$
		λ_2	$\lambda_{\min}$	$(q+1)\lambda_2$	$(q+1)\lambda_{\min}$	$(q+1)\lambda_2$	$(q+1)\lambda_{\min}$	
5	29	6.000	−8.000	6.000	−2.000	2.000	2.000	10.770
7	29	8.000	−6.000	6.000	−6.000	2.000	−6.000	10.770
11	5	4.372	−4.024	3.562	−4.024	3.406	−4.024	4.472
13	17	6.928	−7.851	6.000	−6.685	5.555	−5.555	8.246
13	29	9.932	−9.208	9.000	−9.000	9.000	−9.000	10.770
17	13	6.106	−7.090	6.000	−6.828	6.000	−6.828	7.211
19	5	4.275	−4.274	4.243	−4.000	4.243	−4.000	4.472
19	17	7.671	−7.638	7.128	−7.638	7.128	−7.638	8.246
29	5	4.442	−4.411	4.442	−4.049	4.442	−4.049	4.472
29	13	6.765	−6.949	6.765	−6.912	6.579	−6.912	7.211

The further checks, all passed in every case, are these.

- **Harrow containment.** Every channel eigenvalue, times $q + 1$, lies in the spectrum of the $\mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ Cayley graph to $5 \cdot 10^{-7}$ (for $(13, 17)$: maximum distance $4.4 \cdot 10^{-7}$ on the even block, $3.1 \cdot 10^{-7}$ on the odd). The graph spectrum was computed in double precision on up to 3420 vertices; for $p = 29$ only the extreme eigenvalues were computed, by Lanczos, which is why this is a containment check and not an equality check.
- **Unique fixed point.** The eigenvalue 1 of each block channel has multiplicity one, so the channels are quantum expanders in the sense of Definition 3.16 and not merely bounded.
- **Hecke relation.** $A_q^2 - q1 = A_{q^2}$ on $\mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$, with A_{q^2} built from the $q^2 + q + 1$ normalised quaternions of norm q^2 (307 for $q = 17$, 871 for $q = 29$). Residual exactly 0. This is the tree relation “two steps without backtracking”.
- **Commutation across q .** For $(p; q_1, q_2) = (13; 17, 29), (19; 5, 17), (29; 5, 13)$ the commutator $\|[\Phi_{q_1}^\pm, \Phi_{q_2}^\pm]\|$ is at most $3 \cdot 10^{-15}$ (for $p = 13$: $5.4 \cdot 10^{-16}$ even, $4.5 \cdot 10^{-16}$ odd), and $A_{q_1} A_{q_2} = A_{q_1 q_2}$ exactly, with the $(q_1 + 1)(q_2 + 1) = 540$ quaternions of norm $q_1 q_2$.

7.3 The quantum Ihara zeta of these channels

Numerical result 7.3 (Edge spectrum and Ihara–Bass for $(p, q) = (13, 17)$). [numerical] For $(13, 17)$, odd block, the non-backtracking edge superoperator T on $M_6 \otimes \mathbb{C}^{18}$, of dimension 648, has $|\mu|$ in $\{17, \sqrt{17}, 1\}$ with multiplicities 1, 70, 577, and satisfies the Ihara–Bass identity to 10^{-14} .

The edge superoperator of Definition 3.18 was built directly, and the Ihara–Bass factorisation of Definition 3.8,

$$\det(1 - uT) = (1 - u^2)^{n^2(D-2)/2} \det(1 - u D \Phi_q^- + q u^2), \quad n = 6, D = 18,$$

holds with relative residuals $2.8 \cdot 10^{-15}$ at $u = 0.11$, $2.3 \cdot 10^{-15}$ at $u = 0.2 + 0.07i$ and $1.5 \cdot 10^{-14}$ at $u = -0.23$. The multiplicities $1 + 70 + 577 = 648$ exhaust the edge space, and $\sqrt{q} = 4.12311$. So the quantum Ihara zeta ζ_Φ of this channel satisfies the RH analogue of Definition 3.4 on the nose: every nontrivial zero sits on the critical circle. For every other case the same conclusion follows from the channel spectrum through the quadratic relation $\mu^2 - \lambda\mu + q = 0$ that links an edge eigenvalue to an adjacency eigenvalue λ , without building T .

7.4 What the joint spectrum looks like

For $(13; 17, 29)$ the even block has 19 distinct joint eigenvalue pairs (a_{17}, a_{29}) of the commuting pair Φ_{17}^+, Φ_{29}^+ . Examples, in adjacency units.

(a_{17}, a_{29})	multiplicity	remark
$(18, 30)$	1	trivial: $q + 1$
$(6, 2)$	2	integers
$(3, -1), (3, 3), (3, 9)$	3, 3, 2	integers
$(-5, -5)$	6	integers
$(\frac{3+\sqrt{17}}{2}, -1 - \sqrt{17})$	3	quadratic, field $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{17})$
$(5.6847, -2), (5.5549, -0.3344), (1.7730, 5.1119), \dots$	3 each	higher degree

That the eigenvalues are algebraic integers is not a test: the Cayley adjacency matrix A_q is an integer matrix by construction. What is visible is the structure a Hecke identification would predict, namely joint eigenvalue pairs, small-degree algebraic integers, multiplicities equal to the multiplicity of the corresponding irreducible representation of $\mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ in $W_\pm \otimes \overline{W}_\pm$, and every pair inside the box $[-2\sqrt{q_1}, 2\sqrt{q_1}] \times [-2\sqrt{q_2}, 2\sqrt{q_2}]$.

Conjecture 7.4 (Hecke identification of the Weil–LPS spectra). *[open] The joint spectra of the commuting Weil–LPS channels $\Phi_q^\pm$ are Hecke eigenvalues $a_q(f)$ of weight-2 forms attached to the quaternion algebra ramified at $\{2, \infty\}$, with level determined by p , via Jacquet–Langlands.*

The identification was *not* done here; it needs LMFDB and the Jacquet–Langlands bookkeeping.

7.5 Reading

Riemann channel	Weil–LPS channel at p
commuting dilations by primes	commuting Hecke channels Φ_q , one per LPS prime q
arithmetic quotient supplying expansion	$\mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ as quotient of the $(q+1)$ -regular tree
Weil representation	$W_\pm$ on $\ell^2(\mathbb{F}_p)$, even and odd
joint spectrum = zeros	joint spectrum = Hecke eigenvalues
RH: all modes at $\mathrm{Re} = 1/2$	Ramanujan: all modes at $ \mu = \sqrt{q}$
source of the bound: unknown	source of the bound: Deligne, via LPS

The last row is the honest one. These channels are exactly Ramanujan because Deligne proved the Weil conjectures (Section 9), not because they are channels. What the computation establishes is that the object proposed in the founding session’s handoff exists, is cheap to build, is self-checking at every step, and lands on the parent campaign’s Hilbert space with the parent campaign’s representation.

7.6 Not established

- The identification of the joint spectrum with specific modular forms in LMFDB (conjecture 7.4).
- Any statement about $p \rightarrow \infty$, or about assembling the Φ_q over all p into an object whose rings are the primes; that is the parent repository’s global question in a new guise, recorded as conjecture 14.2 in Section 14.
- Anything about the Riemann hypothesis itself.

8 A Matrix-Product Formulation of the Weil Conjectures for Quadratic Artin–Schreier Curves

The question the founding session put to this family is narrow and answerable: is there an honest matrix product state behind the Weil conjectures for curves, meaning a *fixed* local tensor whose n -site ring contraction is the point count N_n ? In the vocabulary of this book the ingredients line up: $N_n = \#C(\mathbb{F}_{q^n})$ is a ring norm, the Frobenius eigenvalues α_i appearing in $Z_C(u)$ are a transfer spectrum, and the Riemann hypothesis for the curve is the RH analogue of Definition 3.4. What is at issue is only whether the defining equation of the curve is a *local* constraint on the ring. For the quadratic Artin–Schreier family the answer is yes, and the answer stops exactly at degree three.

8.1 The shift picture

By Definition 4.14 the field $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ carries a normal basis $\{\theta, \theta^q, \dots, \theta^{q^{n-1}}\}$ in which Frobenius $x \mapsto x^q$ is the cyclic shift of coordinates. An element of $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ is then a ring of n sites with alphabet $\mathbb{F}_q$, Frobenius is translation by one site, and points over $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ are ring configurations. This is the matrix-product setting of Definition 3.12 with no further choices to make.

For the Artin–Schreier curve $y^q - y = g(x)$ of Definition 4.13, Hilbert 90 reduces the affine count to exponential sums,

$$N_n = q^n + \sum_{a \in \mathbb{F}_q^\times} \mathcal{S}_n(ag), \quad \mathcal{S}_n(g) = \sum_{x \in \mathbb{F}_{q^n}} e_q(\text{tr}_{q^n/q} g(x)), \quad (1)$$

so everything is carried by the $\mathcal{S}_n$. Writing the exponent m of a monomial x^m in base q , $m = \sum_j m_j q^j$, one has $x^m = \prod_j (x^{q^j})^{m_j}$: a product of shifted copies of x , whose range is the number of base- q digits. In a self-dual normal basis, which exists for n odd, the trace form is the dot product, and so for the quadratic family $g(x) = \sum_{j=0}^J a_j x^{1+q^j}$,

$$\text{tr}_{q^n/q} g(x) = \sum_{j=0}^J a_j \sum_i x_i x_{i+j}, \quad (2)$$

a translation-invariant quadratic spin model of range J on the ring. Its partition function is $\text{Tr } E^n$ for the transfer matrix

$$E_{(s_1, \dots, s_J) \rightarrow (s_2, \dots, s_J, x)} = e_q \left(a_0 x^2 + \sum_{j=1}^J a_j s_{J+1-j} x \right), \quad (3)$$

of size q^J , with physical index $\mathbb{F}_q$ and bond dimension q^J . The spins s_i are the J most recent site values; the map reads in the newest value x and forgets the oldest spin s_1 .

Proposition 8.1 (Transfer matrix for the quadratic family). *[sketched]* For $g(x) = \sum_{j=0}^J a_j x^{1+q^j}$ the exponential sum over $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ satisfies $\mathcal{S}_n(g) = -\sum_i \alpha_i^n$, where $\alpha_i = -\lambda_i(E)$ are minus the eigenvalues of the $q^J \times q^J$ transfer matrix (3) of the range- J quadratic spin model on a ring of n sites.

Two remarks on the statement. First, the sign convention is the standing one of Section 2: the note observed $\mathcal{S}_n = \text{Tr } E^n$ for odd n and $\mathcal{S}_n = -\text{Tr } E^n$ for even n , and that apparent “sign flip” is exactly the normalisation $\alpha_i = -\lambda_i(E)$, after which $\mathcal{S}_n = -\sum_i \alpha_i^n$ holds uniformly in n and $L(g, u) = \prod_i (1 - \alpha_i u)$ takes the standard shape of the L -function of an exponential sum. The transfer matrix is minus the Frobenius matrix. Second, the self-dual normal basis was needed only to *see* the locality (2), not for the identity itself, which is why the check below runs over even n as well.

8.2 What was computed

The script brute-forces $\mathcal{S}_n$ in $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ in a polynomial basis, with the modulus verified irreducible, and compares with $\text{Tr } E^n$.

q	$a = (a_0, \dots, a_J)$	$\dim E$	n tested	$\mathcal{S}_n$ against $\text{Tr } E^n$
3	(0, 1)	3	2–7	equal for odd n , sign flip for even n
3	(1, 1)	3	3, 5, 7	equal
5	(0, 1)	5	2–5	equal for odd n , sign flip for even n
3	(0, 1, 1)	9	3, 5, 7	equal
3	(0, 0, 1)	9	3, 5, 7	equal

Numerical result 8.2 (Transfer identity and unitarity, checked). [numerical] For the five (q, a) of the table above and all n listed, the brute-force exponential sum agrees with $\text{Tr } E^n$ up to the sign convention $\alpha_i = -\lambda_i(E)$. For eight (q, a) with $q \in \{3, 5, 7\}$ and $\dim E$ up to 49, every eigenvalue of E has modulus $\sqrt{q}$ and $\|EE^\dagger - qI\| \leq 5.2 \times 10^{-15}$.

The ratios $|\mathcal{S}_n|/q^{n/2}$ are 1 at every tested n except $n = 4$, where they are 3 for $q = 3$ and 5 for $q = 5$: the sums saturate the Weil bound $|\mathcal{S}_n| \leq (\deg g - 1) q^{n/2}$, the maximal-curve phenomenon. The degree of L is $q^J = \deg g - 1$, matching Weil’s count.

8.3 RH is unitarity

Proposition 8.3 (Scaled unitarity of the transfer matrix).

[sketched]

If $a_J \neq 0$ then $EE^\dagger = qI$. Hence $E/\sqrt{q}$ is unitary, every eigenvalue of E has modulus $\sqrt{q}$, and the Weil bound $|\alpha_i| = \sqrt{q}$ holds for the whole quadratic Artin–Schreier family.

The note’s argument is one line. In $(EE^\dagger)_{s's''}$ the oldest spin s_1 , which is the index summed over, appears only through the linear term $a_J s_1(x' - x'')$ of (3); provided $a_J \neq 0$ the sum over s_1 is therefore $q \delta_{x'x''}$. The hypothesis $a_J \neq 0$ is not cosmetic: it is what makes J the true range, and without it the same argument applies at the largest j with $a_j \neq 0$ and a smaller transfer matrix. This is the mechanism already seen for a finite permutation in observation 5.2: the RH analogue is manifest because the transfer matrix is a scaled unitary. In the same terms, rationality of $Z_C(u)$ holds because E is finite, and the note records that the functional equation is the involution $E \mapsto qE^{-\dagger}$, which scaled unitarity makes trivial. The status of Proposition 8.3 is **sketched**: the argument has not been written out as a proof with the index bookkeeping of (3) made explicit, and that write-up, together with the even- n sign convention, is one of the open items of Section 14.

8.4 Where it stops, and why that is the right place

Take a non-quadratic exponent, say $g(x) = x^3$ over $\mathbb{F}_q$ with $q \geq 5$. The base- q expansion of 3 has a single digit, so x^3 is an on-site cubic; but in normal-basis coordinates $\text{tr}_{q^n/q}(x^3) = \sum_{ijk} c_{ijk} x_i x_j x_k$, with the multiplication structure constants c_{ijk} of the basis, which are non-local and depend on n . A self-dual normal basis makes the *bilinear* trace form local; it says nothing about the trilinear one.

g	locality in the shift basis	transfer matrix	RH
quadratic, $\sum_j a_j x^{1+q^j}$	local, range J	$q^J \times q^J$, $\sqrt{q}$ -unitary	manifest
degree ≥ 3 in any digit	non-local, n -dependent	none of fixed size in this basis	Weil / Deligne

Observation 8.4 (The non-quadratic case and Dwork’s operator).

[sketched]

For non-quadratic g the trace form in the shift basis is non-local and depends on n , so no fixed local tensor represents the ring model. The uniform transfer operator that does exist is Dwork’s p -adic operator (Definition 4.15, [8]), which delivers rationality and, through Dwork’s duality, the functional equation, but which sees the p -adic sizes of its eigenvalues and not their complex absolute values.

Dwork’s operator has exactly the form of a coarse-graining tensor-network step, “local weight, then decimate by q ”: multiplication by a splitting function followed by $x^m \mapsto x^{m/q}$, with infinite but nuclear bond dimension, and L as a Fredholm determinant. What it cannot deliver is the RH analogue, because the Newton polygon it computes is a statement about p -adic valuations. That is the structural reason Deligne’s proof [7] lives in ℓ -adic cohomology, and the Weil/Deligne divide is taken up in Section 9. The sums that fall on the far side of the table, cubic Gauss sums and Kloosterman-type sums, are precisely the ones that needed algebraic geometry.

8.5 Not established

The note is explicit about what was not shown. No matrix product state with a fixed local tensor is known here for a non-quadratic Artin–Schreier curve, or for any curve of genus ≥ 1 that is not of this maximal type. Whether a *different* basis of $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$, uniform in n , makes cubic traces local was neither settled nor searched: no candidate was found. And the unitarity argument of Proposition 8.3 remains a sketch.

The boundary itself is the result worth keeping, and it is the same boundary met for graphs and for the Riemann channel: the Ramanujan bound is either manifest, because the transfer matrix is a scaled unitary, or it comes from arithmetic input that sits outside the transfer structure altogether.

9 Deligne's Proof, Told Through Regular Graphs

Expository. Nothing here is new; the point is to isolate what is actually hard in the proof of the Riemann hypothesis over finite fields [7], using the Ihara zeta [20] of a regular graph as the running model, and to read off which ingredients this project has and which it does not.

9.1 One graph, two sides

Fix a finite connected $(q+1)$ -regular graph X . The objects are those of Section 3: non-backtracking walks and prime cycles (Definition 3.5), the count $N_\ell \geq 0$ of closed non-backtracking walks of length ℓ , the Ihara zeta with its Euler product (Definition 3.6), the Hashimoto operator with $N_\ell = \text{Tr } T^\ell$ and $\zeta_X(u) = \det(1 - uT)^{-1}$ (Definition 3.7), and its compression to the adjacency matrix A by Ihara–Bass (Definition 3.8, [1]). Side A is the orbit side, side B the small matrix (Definition 3.1); passing between them is bookkeeping.

Call ± 1 and the pair $\mu \in \{q, 1\}$ from the adjacency eigenvalue $\lambda = q+1$ the *trivial* eigenvalues of T , everything else nontrivial. Then

$$N_\ell = q^\ell + 1 + \sum_{\mu \text{ nontrivial}} \mu^\ell + (|E| - |V|)(1 + (-1)^\ell),$$

with extra terms if X is bipartite: the leading term is the growth rate of the $(q+1)$ -regular tree, and the nontrivial eigenvalues are the error. Since $\mu\mu' = q$, a pair either has both members of modulus $\sqrt{q}$ (when $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$, where they are complex conjugates) or is real with one member larger. So all nontrivial $|\mu| = \sqrt{q}$ iff all nontrivial $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$ iff the error in N_ℓ is $O(q^{\ell/2})$: the Ramanujan property (Definition 3.9) and the RH analogue (Definition 3.4) are the same statement, that closed walks spread as evenly as they possibly could.

Two examples from the founding session. K_4 has $q = 2$, adjacency spectrum $3, -1, -1, -1$, hence $\mu = (-1 \pm i\sqrt{7})/2$ with $|\mu|^2 = 2$: Ramanujan, with $N_3 = 8 + 1 + 6 \cdot \frac{5}{2} = 24$, the oriented pointed triangles. The prism $C_{16} \times K_2$ has an eigenvalue $2 \cos(\pi/8) + 1 \approx 2.848 > 2\sqrt{2}$: a real pole inside the circle and an error growing faster than $2^{\ell/2}$. A long thin graph always fails: a bottleneck gives a real μ near q , and walks pile up on one side of it.

9.2 The same statement for a curve, with one sign changed

A curve C over $\mathbb{F}_q$ has N_ℓ points over $\mathbb{F}_{q^\ell}$: again a nonnegative count, again a generating function $Z_C(u)$ with an Euler product, now over closed points, the orbits of Frobenius Fr on the points over the algebraic closure. Side A is identical in form; side B gives a $2g \times 2g$ matrix (g the genus) with

$$N_\ell = q^\ell + 1 - \text{Tr } \text{Fr}^\ell = q^\ell + 1 - \sum_{i=1}^{2g} \alpha_i^\ell, \quad Z_C(u) = \frac{\det(1 - u\text{Fr})}{(1 - u)(1 - qu)}.$$

	graph	curve
count	closed non-backtracking walks	points over $\mathbb{F}_{q^\ell}$
leading term	$q^\ell + 1$	$q^\ell + 1$
error term	$+\sum \mu^\ell$	$-\sum \alpha_i^\ell$
pairing	$\mu \leftrightarrow q/\mu$	$\alpha_i \leftrightarrow q/\alpha_i$
interesting eigenvalues are	poles of ζ_X	zeros of Z_C
RH	$ \mu = \sqrt{q}$	$ \alpha_i = \sqrt{q}$

Everything matches except the sign of the error term, hence whether the interesting eigenvalues are poles or zeros. For the graph ζ_X is the reciprocal of a polynomial and every eigenvalue is a pole; for the curve the trivial eigenvalues 1 and q are poles and the interesting ones are zeros. This is the sign fixed in Section 2, $\mathcal{S}_n = -\sum_i \alpha_i^n$, and the sign of the explicit formula. For a variety of dimension n the pattern repeats as an alternating sum over $n + 1$ blocks, block i of modulus $q^{i/2}$; the one that matters is the middle, $i = n$.

9.3 What is cheap and what is not

ingredient	graph	variety
side B exists	T plus Ihara–Bass	Grothendieck’s trace formula
the pairing	$\mu\mu' = q$ from Ihara–Bass	Poincaré duality
trivial bound	Perron: $ \mu \leq q$	$ \alpha_i \leq q$
the bound $\sqrt{q}$	<i>false in general</i>	Deligne’s theorem

The first three rows are cheap. Rationality of the zeta function is the first row and nothing more; the trace formula is heavy technology but the same move, that the count is the trace of a power of a finite matrix. The pairing turns the one-sided bound into equality, so the whole problem is one-sided; and the trivial bound is just convergence of the Euler product for $|u| < 1/q$. The gap between q and $\sqrt{q}$ is the entire content.

The last row is where graph and variety part. There is no theorem that a $(q + 1)$ -regular graph is Ramanujan; most are not, the prism is a counterexample, and each Ramanujan construction carries its own proof: arithmetic (Lubotzky–Phillips–Sarnak [27], through RH for a modular curve), probabilistic (Friedman), or interlacing (Marcus–Spielman–Srivastava). So the right question is not how one proves the bound but what varieties have that graphs lack, which makes every one of them Ramanujan. Three things: varieties can be *multiplied*, *sliced* over a curve, and their interesting eigenvalues enter the count with a *minus sign*. A graph has none of the three.

9.4 The engine: power up, dominate, take roots

The trick the proof is built on, in its purest graph form: why the Ramanujan bound is $2\sqrt{q}$. On the infinite $(q + 1)$ -regular tree let c_{2k} count closed ordinary walks of length $2k$ from a root, so the spectral radius of the tree’s adjacency operator is $\lim_k c_{2k}^{1/2k}$. Such a walk is a Dyck path (about 4^k , up to a polynomial factor) together with a fresh neighbour at each of the k outward steps (q choices, $q + 1$ at the root), so $c_{2k} = 4^k q^k$ times a bounded factor times a polynomial in k , and $c_{2k}^{1/2k} \rightarrow 2\sqrt{q}$. Three moves: a nonnegative count dominates a power of an eigenvalue, $c_{2k} = \langle \delta_{\text{root}}, A^{2k} \delta_{\text{root}} \rangle$; the count is known up to a loss that does not grow exponentially in k ; and the $2k$ -th root as $k \rightarrow \infty$ kills every fixed loss. This computation is the tree side of the Ramanujan comparison. Deligne makes the same three moves twice; the nontrivial content is entirely in the second.

9.5 The pointwise theorem, in twisted-graph language

Deligne’s core theorem is not about a variety but about a curve carrying matrix-valued coefficients. A *twist* on a base graph B assigns to each directed edge e an invertible $d \times d$ matrix $\varrho(e)$ with $\varrho(\bar{e}) = \varrho(e)^{-1}$; a closed walk w has holonomy $\varrho(w)$, the ordered product along it, and the twisted zeta is the Artin–Ihara L -function of Definition 3.10,

$$L(u, \varrho) = \prod_P \det(1 - u^{\ell(P)} \varrho(P))^{-1} = \exp\left(\sum_w \frac{1}{\ell(w)} \text{Tr } \varrho(w) u^{\ell(w)}\right) = \det(1 - uT_\varrho)^{-1}.$$

The quantum Ihara zeta of Section 10 is this with B a bouquet of D loops and $\varrho = \text{Ad}(U_i)$ on the i -th loop; a quantum expander is a Ramanujan twist of a bouquet. Two kinds of eigenvalue now live on side B: the *global* ones, the eigenvalues of T_ϱ and poles of L , analogues of the μ ; and the *pointwise* ones, the eigenvalues of each $\varrho(P)$. The twist is *pure with constant* c when every eigenvalue of every $\varrho(P)$ has modulus $c^{\ell(P)}$: a unitary twist is pure with $c = 1$, Deligne's coefficient systems with $c = q^{w/2}$ for an integer weight w (Definition 4.16).

Deligne's pointwise theorem (his Theorem 3.2, in this language): if (a) all traces $\text{Tr } \varrho(w)$ are real, in fact rational; (b) ϱ preserves an alternating pairing up to the scalar $c^{2\ell(w)}$, so eigenvalues of $\varrho(P)$ come in pairs α_i and $c^{2\ell(P)}/\alpha_i$; and (c) the holonomies generate a group as large as (b) permits; then ϱ is pure with constant c .

The note argues in four steps, for a fixed prime cycle P and eigenvalue α_1 of $\varrho(P)$, the target being $|\alpha_1| \leq c^{\ell(P)}$ with (b) supplying equality. *Power up*: replace ϱ by $\varrho^{\otimes 2k}$, so traces become $(\text{Tr } \varrho(w))^{2k}$ and α_1^{2k} is an eigenvalue at P . *Dominate*: by (a) those traces are nonnegative, so every Euler factor of $L_{2k} := L(u, \varrho^{\otimes 2k})$ has nonnegative coefficients and constant term 1, the product dominates any single factor coefficientwise, and the factor at P has a pole at $|u| = |\alpha_1|^{-2k/\ell(P)}$ which a dominated series cannot outrun. *The known pole*: suppose the only poles of L_{2k} were the trivial ones, at $|u| = 1/(q c^{2k})$; then

$$|\alpha_1|^{-2k/\ell(P)} \geq 1/(q c^{2k}) \iff |\alpha_1| \leq c^{\ell(P)} q^{\ell(P)/2k}.$$

Take roots: as $k \rightarrow \infty$ the loss $q^{\ell(P)/2k}$ vanishes. The fixed loss is the single factor q in the trivial pole, paid once by the base curve however large k is.

A graph breaks the third step, and must, since the theorem is false for graphs. Take B a bouquet of two loops with $\varrho(a) = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$, $\varrho(b) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$: traces are integers, so (a); determinants are 1, so (b) with $c = 1$; and the two generate a group as large as $\text{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ permits, so (c). Yet $\varrho(a)$ has eigenvalue $(3+\sqrt{5})/2 > 1$, so the twist is not pure: $L_{2k} = \det(1 - uT_{\varrho^{\otimes 2k}})^{-1}$ has a pole at $|u| = ((3+\sqrt{5})/2)^{-2k}$, far inside $1/q$, from a nontrivial eigenvalue of the twisted edge operator. For a graph every side-B eigenvalue is a pole, so nothing forces the poles to the trivial place. What makes the third step true for a curve is one hypothesis and one structural fact.

9.6 Big monodromy, and the abelian failure

The trivial poles of L_{2k} come from invariant vectors: a vector in the d^{2k} -dimensional coefficient space fixed by every holonomy. On such a vector the twist acts like no twist, so L_{2k} acquires a copy of the untwisted zeta with its pole at $1/q$, rescaled by the scalar the twist puts on the vector; if that scalar is known, so is the pole. The pairing (b) supplies invariants for free, by contracting the $2k$ tensor slots in pairs, each contraction giving a pole at exactly $1/(q c^{2k})$. Hypothesis (c), *big monodromy*, says these are the only invariants: if the holonomies fill out the whole group preserving the pairing, invariant theory makes every invariant of $\varrho^{\otimes 2k}$ a combination of pairwise contractions, so no other trivial pole appears.

Observation 9.1 (The abelian obstruction is inside Deligne's proof). [sketched] Commuting holonomies produce uncontrolled invariants in tensor powers, exactly as commuting Kraus unitaries never give an expander: commuting $\varrho(w)$ have common eigenvectors, and a common eigenvector with eigenvalue $\chi(w)$ becomes invariant in $\varrho^{\otimes N}$ as soon as $\chi^N = 1$, carrying an unknown χ -dependent scalar, so the trivial poles sit where the argument cannot control them. Any Ramanujan lift of the prime dilations must break the commutativity by a quotient, as [27] does with the arithmetic lattice and as Deligne does with the shears of a generic slicing.

In Deligne's setting the commuting case is a coefficient system with abelian monodromy, which can have arbitrary pointwise weights; (c) excludes it. In this project it is the observation of the

founding session that commuting Kraus unitaries never give an expander, the adjoint action of an abelian group having as many invariants as it has joint eigenprojectors: the same obstruction on both sides of the dictionary. Geometrically, big monodromy is verified through shears. The holonomy around each bad slice is the identity plus a rank-one nilpotent along one vector, those vectors are carried to one another by the holonomy group, and a theorem of Kazhdan and Margulis says a group generated by one conjugacy class of shears and acting without invariant subspaces is automatically as large as the pairing allows. Big monodromy is the statement that the bad slices are all alike, which holds because they are generic.

9.7 The sign

For a graph, side B is the one matrix T_ϱ and every eigenvalue is a pole. For a curve with coefficients the trace formula has two blocks of opposite sign,

$$\sum_{w: \ell(w)=\ell} \text{Tr } \varrho(w) = \text{Tr}(\text{Fr}^\ell \mid \text{invariant}) - \text{Tr}(\text{Fr}^\ell \mid \text{interesting}), \quad L(u, \varrho) = \frac{\det(1 - u\text{Fr} \mid \text{interesting})}{\det(1 - u\text{Fr} \mid \text{invariant})}.$$

The invariant block is the one big monodromy computes, and it produces the poles; the interesting block produces zeros, and zeros do not obstruct convergence, so the radius of convergence of L_{2k} is set by the invariant block alone. That is the third step, and it is the minus sign of the table above: positivity of counts is available on both sides, but on the graph side it constrains the sum of everything, which is the Perron bound and no more, while on the curve side the interesting eigenvalues are subtracted, so positivity bounds them above by the trivial ones and even tensor powers squeeze the bound to equality. The two-loop bouquet is not a curve because its walk counts cannot be written with the interesting part subtracted.

9.8 From pointwise to global: slice, bound, multiply

Slice. Take a one-parameter family of hyperplane sections of a variety X of dimension n ; the parameter runs over a curve and all but finitely many slices are smooth of dimension $n - 1$. Up to pieces already understood, the middle block of X is the interesting block of that base curve with coefficients, the coefficient at a parameter value being the middle block of the slice there. In graph terms this is the Artin–Ihara factorisation (Definition 3.10) used in Section 10, with the fibre replaced by a variety of one dimension less. The coefficients satisfy (a), (b), (c): the pairing is Poincaré duality on the slice, big monodromy is the shear argument, and the traces are rational because the zeta of a slice is rational with rational coefficients, off which the blocks known by induction are peeled. So they are pure with $c = q^{(n-1)/2}$.

Bound. With pure coefficients the Euler product over the base converges absolutely for $|u| < 1/(qc)$, there being about q^ℓ/ℓ prime cycles of length ℓ each with holonomy of norm c^ℓ . So the interesting block has no eigenvalue larger than $qc = q^{(n+1)/2}$, where RH wants $q^{n/2}$: a loss of one factor $\sqrt{q}$, paid by the base being a curve, independent of n .

Multiply. The product X^k has dimension nk and its middle block contains the k -fold tensor products of the middle block of X , so the products $\alpha_1 \cdots \alpha_k$ are among its eigenvalues. The bound applied to X^k still loses one factor $\sqrt{q}$, because the base of a slicing is always a curve, whence

$$|\alpha_i|^k \leq q^{(nk+1)/2} \implies |\alpha_i| \leq q^{n/2} q^{1/2k} \xrightarrow{k \rightarrow \infty} q^{n/2},$$

with duality giving the reverse inequality: the engine a second time, count, fixed loss, roots. The pointwise theorem is what makes the last move legitimate, since the slices of X^k have dimension

$nk - 1$, far above anything the induction on dimension knows, so their purity must come from rationality and big monodromy alone. That is why the core theorem is stated for coefficients on a curve: it certifies coefficients in any dimension at the price of one curve. Even for a curve C the argument passes through C^k for all k ; the surface $C \times C$ is where Weil’s proof lived, and the products are the mechanism. The blocks $i \neq n$ follow by induction from lower-dimensional sections and from duality.

9.9 What the proof does not do

It never exhibits a Hermitian structure. Weil’s proof for curves does: by the Hodge index theorem the intersection form on $C \times C$ is definite on the relevant part, which makes $\text{Fr}/\sqrt{q}$ unitary for an explicit positive inner product on the middle block and produces a Hilbert–Pólya operator (Definition 4.7). In graph terms, on the nontrivial part T is $\sqrt{q}$ times a unitary in some inner product, which for the block $\begin{pmatrix} \lambda & -q \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$ holds exactly when $|\lambda| < 2\sqrt{q}$. Grothendieck’s plan was to prove a definite form in all dimensions, the standard conjectures, and deduce RH as Weil had; that plan is still open. Deligne bypassed it: no form, no operator, only positivity and a limit. RH over finite fields is therefore a theorem, while in dimension above one the inner product that would make Frobenius normal is not known to exist.

The Artin–Schreier computation of Section 8 sits on the Weil side of this divide: $EE^\dagger = qI$ is manifest from Parseval for the additive characters (Proposition 8.3), an explicit inner product. Deligne’s proof is what one has when no such structure is in sight. Two honesty notes the note records: the Ramanujan property of the LPS graphs of Section 7 needs only the curve case, since Eichler–Shimura transports Hecke eigenvalues to Frobenius eigenvalues of a modular curve, so Weil’s theorem suffices there and Deligne’s method is what extends it to higher weight; and the technology behind “side B exists” is the largest single piece of the proof by page count, though not by idea.

9.10 What this says for the project

Observation 9.2 (The three ingredients, and no Hermitian form). [sketched] Deligne’s proof uses three ingredients that a Hilbert–Pólya approach would have to replace: products, under which eigenvalues multiply while the trivial loss stays fixed; slicing over a curve, which keeps that loss at one factor $\sqrt{q}$ in every dimension; and the sign, which makes the interesting eigenvalues zeros rather than poles, so that positivity of the counts bounds them. It exhibits no Hermitian form and no operator.

- **Which ingredients ζ has.** The zeros are subtracted from the prime count, so ζ is on the curve side of the table, not the graph side, and the positivity $\Lambda(n) \geq 0$ is the right kind. The sign and the positivity are present; the product is absent, since there is no $X \times X$ with ζ as its slice, so the multiply step has nothing to act on. This is the standard diagnosis, stated in the terms of this section.
- **The number-field shadow of the pointwise theorem is Rankin–Selberg.** For a modular form the Euler product of $L(f \times \bar{f})$ has nonnegative coefficients and a known pole, and dominating one local factor gives $|a_p| \leq p^{(k-1)/2} \cdot p^{1/2}$, the same fixed loss; each symmetric-power L -function whose poles are known shaves it (Kim–Sarnak’s 7/64 is the current state). Knowing the poles of all the tensor-power L -functions is the analogue of big monodromy; over number fields that is Langlands functoriality, unproved.
- **The abelian obstruction is inside the proof** (observation 9.1), on both sides of the dictionary.

- **Ramanujan without Hermiticity is possible.** Deligne’s route and the interlacing route both reach the spectral bound with no Hilbert–Pólya operator. For the steering question of where Hermiticity enters, this is the cleanest evidence that it need not enter at all; what must enter is a positivity plus an operation under which eigenvalues multiply at fixed loss.

10 The Ihara–Bass Formula for an Arbitrary Kraus Family

This is the load-bearing section of the book. The classical Ihara–Bass formula (Definition 3.8) compresses a determinant on the edge space of a regular graph to one on the vertex space, and Definition 3.18 lifts the edge operator to superoperators. The question the founding session left open, and which TJO steered towards, is whether the compression survives when the Kraus operators are not unitary. It does, at the price of two u -dependent operators in place of the adjacency matrix and the degree.

Status. Theorem 10.1 and its three corollaries are tagged **proved**. The author is **claudé:fable-5.1**; the reviewers are of a different model, **claudé:opus**; and their reports in **notes/reviews/** — a round-1 algebra report, a round-1 provenance report, and a round-2 re-verification — return **VALID** on every verdict. Only one model family was declared for this campaign, so **proved** here means exactly that: author $\neq$ reviewer, inside one family. The two **numerical** rows are independent evidence.

10.1 Setting and conventions

- $\mathcal{V}$ is a finite-dimensional complex vector space, $N = \dim \mathcal{V}$. In the application $\mathcal{V} = M_n$ with the Hilbert–Schmidt inner product, so $N = n^2$.
- $D = 2m$ is even, and ι is a fixed-point-free involution on $[D] = \{1, \dots, D\}$, the *reversal*; we write $\bar{i} = \iota(i)$, so that $\bar{\bar{i}} = i$.
- $\mathcal{E}_1, \dots, \mathcal{E}_D \in \text{End}(\mathcal{V})$ are arbitrary linear maps. No invertibility, positivity or unitarity is assumed.
- The edge space is $\mathcal{W} = \mathcal{V} \otimes \mathbb{C}^D$, with $\mathbb{C}^D$ spanned by $|1\rangle, \dots, |D\rangle$; an element is $x = \sum_i x_i \otimes |i\rangle$ with $x_i \in \mathcal{V}$ its *component* at i .
- $T \in \text{End}(\mathcal{W})$ is the quantum Hashimoto operator of Definition 3.18, $T(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \sum_{j \neq \bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i v \otimes |j\rangle$, and $\zeta_T(u) = \det_{\mathcal{W}}(1 - uT)^{-1}$, a rational function of $u \in \mathbb{C}$.
- $\|\cdot\|$ is the operator norm; any submultiplicative norm on $\text{End}(\mathcal{V})$ would do. Determinants carry the space they are taken over, $\det_{\mathcal{V}}$ and $\det_{\mathcal{W}}$.
- Sylvester’s identity $\det(1 - XY) = \det(1 - YX)$, for $X: \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \mathcal{W}$ and $Y: \mathcal{W} \rightarrow \mathcal{V}$, is used without further comment; so is the block determinant with identity diagonal blocks, $\det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & B \\ C & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \det(1 - CB) = \det(1 - BC)$ (Schur complement, then Sylvester).

The Kraus case. $\mathcal{V} = M_n$; $A_1, \dots, A_m \in M_n$ are arbitrary, $A_{m+k} = A_k^\dagger$, $\iota(k) = m + k$, and $\mathcal{E}_i = \text{Ad}(A_i): X \mapsto A_i X A_i^\dagger$. With column stacking (Section 2), $\text{Ad}(A) = \bar{A} \otimes A$ as an $n^2 \times n^2$ matrix, so $\text{Tr}_{\mathcal{V}} \text{Ad}(A) = |\text{Tr } A|^2$ and $\text{Ad}(A) \text{Ad}(B) = \text{Ad}(AB)$.

Auxiliary maps. Three maps do all the work: **R** propagates along an edge, **S** starts along every edge, **J** is the backtracking term.

$$\mathbf{R}: \mathcal{W} \rightarrow \mathcal{V}, \quad \mathbf{R}(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \mathcal{E}_i v; \quad \mathbf{S}: \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \mathcal{W}, \quad \mathbf{S}v = \sum_{j=1}^D v \otimes |j\rangle; \quad \mathbf{J}(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \mathcal{E}_i v \otimes |\bar{i}\rangle.$$

The two u -dependent operators on $\mathcal{V}$ are the *deformed adjacency* and the *deformed degree*,

$$\mathcal{A}(u) = u \sum_{i=1}^D \mathcal{E}_i (1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_i)^{-1}, \quad \mathcal{D}(u) = u^2 \sum_{i=1}^D \mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_i (1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_i)^{-1}.$$

The zeta variable is u throughout (Section 2); the channel normalisation $\Sigma = \sum_i \mathcal{E}_i = D\Phi$ is the one fixed there, and nothing below depends on it.

10.2 Statement

Theorem 10.1 (Ihara–Bass for an arbitrary family of superoperators). *[proved] Let $u \in \mathbb{C}$ be such that $1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i$ is invertible for every $i \in [D]$. Then*

$$\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1 - uT) = \prod_{\{i, \bar{i}\}} \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i) \cdot \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 + \mathcal{D}(u) - \mathcal{A}(u)),$$

the product being over the m unordered pairs $\{i, \bar{i}\}$, which is well defined because $\det(1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i) = \det(1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}})$. The hypothesis holds for all $|u| < (\max_i \|\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i\|)^{-1/2}$, and for all u if every $\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i = 0$; the identity holds pointwise at every such u , and since the left side is a polynomial of degree $\leq ND$ and the right side is rational, the two sides agree as rational functions.

Corollary 10.2 (Kraus families and positivity of side A). *[proved] For arbitrary $A_1, \dots, A_m \in M_n$ with the adjoint pairing above, $\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1 - uT) = \prod_{k=1}^m \det(1 - u^2 \text{Ad}(A_k^\dagger A_k)) \cdot \det(1 + \mathcal{D}(u) - \mathcal{A}(u))$, valid for $|u| < \min_k \|A_k\|^{-2}$; here $\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i$ is $\text{Ad}(A_k^\dagger A_k)$ for $i = k \leq m$ and $\text{Ad}(A_k A_k^\dagger)$ for $i = m + k$, both positive semidefinite. Moreover, for every $\ell \geq 1$,*

$$\text{Tr}_{\mathcal{W}} T^\ell = \sum_{\substack{(i_1, \dots, i_\ell) \in [D]^\ell \\ i_{k+1} \neq i_k \text{ (} k \in \mathbb{Z}/\ell \text{)}}} |\text{Tr}(A_{i_\ell} \cdots A_{i_1})|^2 \geq 0,$$

so $\zeta_T(u) = \exp(\sum_\ell u^\ell \text{Tr} T^\ell / \ell)$ has nonnegative Taylor coefficients, and $\zeta_T(u) = \prod_P \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u^{\ell(P)} \text{Ad}(A_P))^{-1}$ over primitive cyclically non-backtracking classes P of length $\ell(P)$, with A_P the ordered product along P .

Corollary 10.3 (Inverse pairing: the unitary case). *[proved] If $\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} = \mathcal{E}_i^{-1}$ for all i — in particular for unitary Kraus operators with $U_{\bar{i}} = U_i^\dagger = U_i^{-1}$ — then, with $\Sigma = \sum_i \mathcal{E}_i$,*

$$\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1 - uT) = (1 - u^2)^{N(D-2)/2} \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u\Sigma + (D-1)u^2).$$

For $\mathcal{V} = M_n$ and $\Sigma = D\Phi$ this is the formula recorded as item 1 of `HANDOFF.md` and, on the bouquet, equation (2.11) of Matsuura–Ohta [30].

Corollary 10.4 (Which factor carries the spectrum). *[proved] The poles of ζ_T lie among the roots of $\det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 + \mathcal{D}(u) - \mathcal{A}(u)) = 0$ together with the points $u^2 = 1/\lambda$ for $\lambda \in \text{spec}(\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i) \setminus \{0\}$; the latter may cancel against poles of the second factor, as they do in Corollary 10.3 (exponent $ND/2$ against $-N$, a total cancellation when $D = 2$). For $D = 2$ in general, $T = \mathcal{E}_1 \oplus \mathcal{E}_2$ on $\mathcal{W} = \mathcal{V} \oplus \mathcal{V}$, since the only non-backtracking successor of i is i itself, so $\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1 - uT) = \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u\mathcal{E}_1) \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u\mathcal{E}_2)$. Conversely a pole of the second factor, which can only sit where some $1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i$ is singular, is not a pole of ζ_T unless it survives multiplication by the first.*

10.3 Proof of the theorem

The proof is written in Lamport structure: each step is a claim followed by its own proof, and the last step assembles them.

Proof of Theorem 10.1. ASSUME: $u \in \mathbb{C}$ with $1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i$ invertible for all $i \in [D]$. PROVE: the displayed identity.

- (1)1. **The decomposition $T = \text{SR} - \text{J}$.** *Proof.* On $v \otimes |i\rangle$, $\text{SR}(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \sum_j \mathcal{E}_i v \otimes |j\rangle$ and $\text{J}(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \mathcal{E}_i v \otimes |\bar{i}\rangle$, so $(\text{SR} - \text{J})(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \sum_{j \neq \bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i v \otimes |j\rangle = T(v \otimes |i\rangle)$. Both sides are linear and these vectors span $\mathcal{W}$. $\square$
- (1)2. **Block structure of J .** For each pair $p = \{i, \bar{i}\}$ put $\mathcal{W}_p = \mathcal{V} \otimes \text{span}\{|i\rangle, |\bar{i}\rangle\}$. Then $\mathcal{W} = \bigoplus_p \mathcal{W}_p$, $\text{J}\mathcal{W}_p \subseteq \mathcal{W}_p$, and in the ordered decomposition $\mathcal{W}_p = \mathcal{V} \oplus \mathcal{V}$ (component at i , component at $\bar{i}$), $\text{J}|_{\mathcal{W}_p} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \\ \mathcal{E}_i & 0 \end{pmatrix}$. *Proof.* J sends the component at i to the component at $\bar{i}$ through $\mathcal{E}_i$, and the component at $\bar{i}$ to the component at i through $\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}$, using $\bar{\bar{i}} = i$. The direct sum is the partition of $[D]$ into ι -orbits, which have size two because ι is fixed-point-free. $\square$
- (1)3. **$1+u\text{J}$ is invertible, with $\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1+u\text{J}) = \prod_p \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1-u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)$.** *Proof.* By (1)2, $\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1+u\text{J}) = \prod_p \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & u\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \\ u\mathcal{E}_i & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \prod_p \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1-u^2\mathcal{E}_i\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}) = \prod_p \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1-u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)$, by the block determinant and then Sylvester. Each factor is nonzero by ASSUME. $\square$
- (1)4. **Explicit inverse on a pair.** Write $B = u\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}$, $C = u\mathcal{E}_i$, $P = (1 - BC)^{-1} = (1 - u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)^{-1}$ and $Q = (1 - CB)^{-1} = (1 - u^2\mathcal{E}_i\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}})^{-1}$, both existing by ASSUME (the second is the hypothesis at the index $\bar{i}$). Then $(1+u\text{J})^{-1}|_{\mathcal{W}_p} = \begin{pmatrix} P & -BQ \\ -CP & Q \end{pmatrix}$. *Proof.* Multiply out: $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & B \\ C & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} P & -BQ \\ -CP & Q \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} (1-BC)P & -BQ+BPQ \\ CP-CP & (1-CB)Q \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$. A right inverse of a square operator on a finite-dimensional space is the inverse. $\square$
- (1)5. **Sylvester step.** $\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1-uT) = \det_{\mathcal{W}}(1+u\text{J}) \cdot \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1-u\text{R}(1+u\text{J})^{-1}\text{S})$. *Proof.* By (1)1, $1-uT = 1+u\text{J} - u\text{SR} = (1+u\text{J})(1-u(1+u\text{J})^{-1}\text{SR})$, the inverse existing by (1)3. Take determinants and apply Sylvester with $X = u(1+u\text{J})^{-1}\text{S}: \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \mathcal{W}$ and $Y = \text{R}: \mathcal{W} \rightarrow \mathcal{V}$. $\square$
- (1)6. **Computation of $M(u) := \text{R}(1+u\text{J})^{-1}\text{S}$.** It equals $\sum_{i=1}^D (\mathcal{E}_i - u\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)(1 - u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)^{-1}$. *Proof.* For $v \in \mathcal{V}$, $\text{S}v$ has component v at every index. By (1)4, on the pair $p = \{i, \bar{i}\}$ the vector $(1+u\text{J})^{-1}\text{S}v$ has component $(P - BQ)v$ at i and $(-CP + Q)v$ at $\bar{i}$. Applying R , which applies $\mathcal{E}_i$ to the component at i , $\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}$ to the component at $\bar{i}$, and sums over all indices, and substituting B, C, P, Q , the pair p contributes

$$\mathcal{E}_i P - u\mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} Q + \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} Q - u\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i P = (\mathcal{E}_i - u\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)P + (\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} - u\mathcal{E}_i\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}})Q.$$

The first summand is the i -th term of the claimed sum and the second is the $\bar{i}$ -th, since $Q = (1 - u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)^{-1}$. Summing over the m pairs gives the sum over all D indices. $\square$

- (1)7. **$1-uM(u) = 1 + \mathcal{D}(u) - \mathcal{A}(u)$.** *Proof.* Expand (1)6 linearly: $uM(u) = u \sum_i \mathcal{E}_i (1 - u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)^{-1} - u^2 \sum_i \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i (1 - u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)^{-1} = \mathcal{A}(u) - \mathcal{D}(u)$. $\square$
- (1)8. **QED.** *Proof.* Combine (1)5, (1)3 and (1)7. Steps (1)1–(1)7 hold pointwise at every u satisfying ASSUME, with no analyticity used. The bound $|u| < (\max_i \|\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i\|)^{-1/2}$ makes $\|u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i\| < 1$, so the Neumann series supplies the inverses and ASSUME holds there. The set of admissible u is cofinite: its complement is the zero set of the polynomial $\prod_i \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)$, which equals 1 at $u = 0$ and so is not identically zero. Two rational functions agreeing on a cofinite set are equal. $\square$

$\square$

10.4 Proofs of the corollaries

Proof of Corollary 10.2. $\mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} = \text{Ad}(A_{\bar{i}}) \text{Ad}(A_i) = \text{Ad}(A_{\bar{i}} A_i)$, which is $\text{Ad}(A_k^\dagger A_k)$ or $\text{Ad}(A_k A_k^\dagger)$; for $P \geq 0$ with eigenvalues p_a , $\text{Ad}(P) = \bar{P} \otimes P$ has spectrum $\{\bar{p}_a p_b\} \subseteq [0, \infty)$, and $\|\text{Ad}(A_k^\dagger A_k)\| = \|A_k\|^4$, so the hypothesis of Theorem 10.1 holds for $|u| < \min_k \|A_k\|^{-2}$; the two orderings of a pair have equal determinant by Sylvester, leaving one factor per k . For the trace formula, induction on ℓ gives $T^\ell(v \otimes |i_1\rangle) = \sum \mathcal{E}_{i_\ell} \cdots \mathcal{E}_{i_1} v \otimes |i_{\ell+1}\rangle$, summed over $(i_2, \dots, i_{\ell+1})$ with $i_{k+1} \neq \bar{i}_k$ for $k = 1, \dots, \ell$. Tracing over $\mathcal{W} = \mathcal{V} \otimes \mathbb{C}^D$ sets $i_{\ell+1} = i_1$, which adds the cyclic condition $i_1 \neq \bar{i}_\ell$, and leaves $\text{Tr}_{\mathcal{V}} \text{Ad}(A_{i_\ell} \cdots A_{i_1}) = |\text{Tr}(A_{i_\ell} \cdots A_{i_1})|^2$. Nonnegativity of the coefficients of $\log \zeta_T = \sum_\ell u^\ell \text{Tr } T^\ell / \ell$ implies nonnegativity for $\zeta_T = \exp(\cdot)$. The Euler product is the standard regrouping of cyclic words into powers of primitive classes, using $\sum_{k \geq 1} \frac{u^{k\ell(P)}}{k} \text{Tr } \text{Ad}(A_P)^k = -\log \det(1 - u^{\ell(P)} \text{Ad}(A_P))$, valid for $|u|$ small. $\square$

Proof of Corollary 10.3. With $\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i = 1$ each pair factor is $\det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u^2) = (1 - u^2)^N$, so the product is $(1 - u^2)^{ND/2}$; and $\mathcal{A}(u) = \frac{u}{1-u^2} \Sigma$, $\mathcal{D}(u) = \frac{Du^2}{1-u^2}$. Hence $1 + \mathcal{D}(u) - \mathcal{A}(u) = \frac{1}{1-u^2} (1 - u\Sigma + (D-1)u^2)$, whose determinant is $(1 - u^2)^{-N} \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u\Sigma + (D-1)u^2)$. The total exponent is $ND/2 - N = N(D-2)/2$. The computation divides by $1 - u^2$ and so is carried out for $u^2 \neq 1$; both sides are polynomials in u , so the identity extends to $u^2 = 1$. $\square$

Proof of Corollary 10.4. Immediate from the factorisation: a zero of the polynomial $\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1 - uT)$ is a zero of the product, each factor is analytic away from the points named, and a polynomial has no poles, so every pole of the second factor is cancelled by a zero of the first. $\square$

10.5 Provenance and relation to the literature

Watanabe and Fukumizu [36] prove an Ihara–Bass formula for graph zeta functions with arbitrary matrix weights, in the shape $\det(I + \hat{\mathcal{D}} - \hat{\mathcal{A}}) \prod_{[e]} \det(I - u_e u_{\bar{e}})$, with $\hat{\mathcal{D}}$ and $\hat{\mathcal{A}}$ built from $(I - u_e u_{\bar{e}})^{-1}$ exactly as $\mathcal{D}(u)$ and $\mathcal{A}(u)$ are; the byte-verified quotes are in Section 11. On a one-vertex graph whose $2m$ directed edges are $[D]$ with reversal ι , and with $u_e = u \mathcal{E}_e$, their right-hand side becomes the right-hand side of Theorem 10.1 after the push-through identity $\mathcal{E}_i(1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i)^{-1} = (1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}})^{-1} \mathcal{E}_i$ and the relabelling $i \leftrightarrow \bar{i}$ in the degree term. Two further conventions differ and wash out of $\det(1 - u \cdot)$: they compose a prime cycle in the order opposite to our $\mathcal{E}_{i_\ell} \cdots \mathcal{E}_{i_1}$, and their edge operator weights the target edge where T weights the source. Reversal of words is a bijection of cyclically non-backtracking words because ι is an involution, and $\det(1 - XY) = \det(1 - YX)$.

The framing matters, and was corrected by the round-1 provenance review: their corollary is stated for loopless graphs (their graphs are hypergraphs with two-element hyperedges), so a bouquet is not one of their graphs and their corollary does not apply to it. Theorem 10.1 is therefore the loop-admitting bouquet analogue of their arbitrary-weight corollary, not an instance of it; their proof goes through a hypergraph theorem, the proof above is direct. The shape-matching itself is checked numerically only (`notes/reviews/scratch_wf_mo_conventions.py`).

Matsuura and Ohta [30] treat invertible edge weights on a general graph, which is Corollary 10.3 in that generality; on a bouquet with $X_e = U_e \otimes U_e^\dagger$ their equation (2.11) is the formula of `HANDOFF.md` item 1. No local source covers arbitrary weights on a bouquet.

10.6 Numerical checks

Numerical result 10.5 (Ihara–Bass for random unitary Kraus sets). `[numerical]` For Haar-random unitary Kraus sets closed under adjoint, Corollary 10.3 holds at $u \in \{0.13, 0.29 + 0.11i, -0.4\}$ with relative error at most $2.1 \cdot 10^{-15}$ for $(n, D) = (3, 4)$ and at most $3.9 \cdot 10^{-15}$ for $(n, D) = (4, 6)$. The four

largest eigenvalues of $\Sigma = D\Phi$ are 1.465, 1.850, 3.622, 4.000 for (3, 4) against the Ramanujan bound $2\sqrt{q} = 3.464$, and 2.782, 3.128, 3.594, 6.000 for (4, 6) against 4.472: the first instance violates the bound of Definition 3.17 and the second satisfies it. (`scripts/qihara.py`, `outputs/qihara.txt`.)

Numerical result 10.6 (The general formula in five configurations). [numerical]
Theorem 10.1, in both the $1 - uM(u)$ and the displayed $1 + \mathcal{D}(u) - \mathcal{A}(u)$ form, at three values of u (one complex), with maximal relative error per configuration as in the table; the trace formula of Corollary 10.2 for $\ell \leq 4$ to $5.5 \cdot 10^{-12}$; and exact verification in rational arithmetic (sympy) for $(N, D) = (1, 4), (2, 4), (2, 6)$. (`scripts/qihara_general.py`, `outputs/qihara_general.txt`.)

configuration	parameters	max. relative error
Gaussian Kraus operators, adjoint pairing	$n = 3, D = 4$	$2.1 \cdot 10^{-15}$
canonical-form MPS tensors and adjoints	$n = 3, D = 4$	$2.0 \cdot 10^{-15}$
generic real superoperators, involution (1 2)(3 4)	$n = 3, D = 4$	$6.7 \cdot 10^{-16}$
single Kraus pair, with the direct-sum check	$n = 3, D = 2$	$1.4 \cdot 10^{-15}$
unitary Kraus, against Corollary 10.3	$n = 3, D = 4$	$1.3 \cdot 10^{-15}$

10.7 What this does and does not give

It gives the compression for *every* matrix product state transfer matrix $\Sigma = \sum_i \text{Ad}(A_i)$, with the physical index doubled by the adjoints. The price of dropping unitarity is that the degree term $(D - 1)u^2$ becomes the operator $\mathcal{D}(u)$ and the adjacency term $u\Sigma$ becomes the deformed channel $\mathcal{A}(u)$, both depending on u through $(1 - u^2 \text{Ad}(A_k^\dagger A_k))^{-1}$.

It does not give a Ramanujan reading by itself. Without $\mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_i = 1$ there is no quadratic relation $\mu\mu' = q$ pairing the eigenvalues of T with those of Σ . What replaces it, and whether canonical form (Definition 3.14) buys anything, is conjecture 14.1.

Side A is unconditionally positive: $\text{Tr } T^\ell = \sum_P |\text{Tr } A_P|^2 \geq 0$ for any Kraus family, so the primes of this zeta are the primitive cyclically non-backtracking words in the A_k and $A_k^\dagger$, with real nonnegative multiplicities.

Observation 10.7 (RH for the quantum Ihara zeta is Hastings' bound). [sketched] For unitary Kraus operators closed under adjoint, Corollary 10.3 attaches to each eigenvalue λ of $\Sigma = D\Phi$ the quadratic $1 - \lambda u + qu^2 = (1 - \mu u)(1 - \mu' u)$ with $\mu\mu' = q = D - 1$ and $\mu + \mu' = \lambda$; the eigenvalues λ are real because Σ is Hilbert–Schmidt self-adjoint for an adjoint-closed set. Both roots then have $|\mu| = \sqrt{q}$ exactly when $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$. Hence every nontrivial pole of ζ_Φ lies on the circle $|u| = q^{-1/2}$ if and only if $D\lambda_2 \leq 2\sqrt{D - 1}$, which is Hastings' bound λ_H [19] in the adjacency units of Section 2: the Riemann hypothesis for this zeta is exactly the statement that Φ is a Ramanujan quantum expander (Definition 3.17). The note records this as an observation, not found in the literature in this form; it is tagged **sketched** because it has had no reviewer.

11 Prior Art for the Quantum Ihara Zeta

The search of 2026-09-12 used three literature agents (graph zetas and L -functions; quantum expanders and free probability; direct phrase search), after which every load-bearing sentence was rechecked against the arXiv T_EX source under `refs/src/` (fetched by `refs/fetch_sources.sh`, hashes in `refs/manifest.sha256`). Each quote below is reproduced verbatim from `db/provenance.tsv` and carries its locus; sources with no local T_EX are unverified and are used for attribution only.

11.1 The object under examination

The object is the one fixed in Definition 3.18: for a unital channel $\Phi(X) = \frac{1}{D} \sum_i U_i X U_i^\dagger$ with unitary Kraus operators closed under adjoint, the non-backtracking edge superoperator T on $M_n \otimes \mathbb{C}^D$ and the zeta $\zeta_\Phi(u) = \det(1 - uT)^{-1}$. The founding session made four claims about it. First, an Ihara–Bass identity,

$$\det(1 - uT) = (1 - u^2)^{n^2(D-2)/2} \det(1 - u D\Phi + (D-1)u^2). \quad (4)$$

Second, that all nontrivial poles of ζ_Φ lie on $|u| = (D-1)^{-1/2}$ if and only if Φ is a Ramanujan quantum expander (Definition 3.17). Third, that ζ_Φ is the Artin–Ihara L -function (Definition 3.10) of the bouquet with $D/2$ loops twisted by $\varrho: g_i \mapsto \text{Ad}(U_i)$, with $\text{Tr } T^\ell = \sum_w |\text{Tr } U_w|^\ell$ over cyclically reduced words w of length ℓ . Fourth, that the Weil representation of $\text{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ with LPS generators gives an instance where the analogue of the Riemann hypothesis holds exactly. Alongside these sits the matrix-product-state reading (channel as transfer matrix, ζ_Φ as a generating function of ring norms, one correlation length as the Riemann hypothesis, AKLT giving K_4).

11.2 Verdict

claim	status	where
1, Ihara–Bass with $\text{Ad}(U_i)$ weights	known	Matsuura–Ohta 2022, eqs. (2.8) to (2.11) with $X_e = U_e \otimes U_e^\dagger$, loops allowed; the arbitrary-weight formula of Watanabe–Fukumizu 2011 for loopless graphs; twisted zetas back to Sunada 1986 and Hashimoto 1989 (unverified, secondary)
3, trace formula, free-group L -function	known	Matsuura–Ohta 2022 eq. (2.10); Matsuura–Ohta 2026, where the object is named an Artin–Ihara L -function for a representation extended to $U(N_c)$
2, poles on the critical circle iff Hastings–Ramanujan	not found	zero hits for any zeta or Ihara combined with channel, Kraus, CP map or expander; Matsuura–Ohta contain none of the words Ramanujan, expander, Riemann hypothesis; Bordenave–Collins have the operator but no determinant and no zeta
4, exactly Ramanujan channels from LPS	mechanism known, instance not	Harrow 2008 plus LPS; Iyer, Jain, Jordan and Somma (Feb 2026) state it with $SU(2)$ irreps and call explicit Ramanujan quantum expanders a longstanding open problem; no Weil-representation instance and no zeta
MPS and ring-norm reading, AKLT = K_4	not found	no hits for Ihara or zeta combined with matrix product state, transfer matrix or AKLT

11.3 Matsuura and Ohta

Cited fact 11.1 (Extended Ihara zeta with invertible matrix weights). [cited] Suppose $\{X_e\}_{e \in E}$ are invertible matrices of size K living on each edge. (2204.06424:main.tex:476), with $\zeta_G(q; X) \equiv \det \Bigl(\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \sum_{C \in R_k} \text{Tr } P_C(X) \Bigr)^{-1}$ (2204.06424:main.tex:479-482) for the edge-matrix determinant, $\zeta_G(q; X) = \exp \left(\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \sum_{C \in R_k} \text{Tr } P_C(X) \right)$ (2204.06424:main.tex:503-505) for the trace formula over reduced cycles, and the three-term identity $\zeta_G(q; X) = (1 - q^2)^{-(n_V - n_E)K} \det \Bigl(\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \sum_{C \in R_k} \text{Tr } P_C(X) \Bigr)^{-1}$ (2204.06424:main.tex:516-519), proved by the classical route: The following proof is parallel to the one given in [bass1992ihara] for the original Ihara zeta function (2204.06424:main.tex:533-534). This is claim 1 with arbitrary invertible matrix weights in place of $\text{Ad}(U_i)$, and claim 3 in the shape of a sum over cyclically reduced classes.

Cited fact 11.2 (Adjoint weights and the name Artin–Ihara L -function). [cited] The weights they apply the formula to are the adjoint ones, with $X_e = U_e \otimes U_e^\dagger$ (2204.06424:main.tex:696); the 2026 paper names the resulting object an Artin–Ihara L -function for a representation R of a finite group extended to $U(N_c)$, taking R to be the adjoint representation with $\varrho_{\text{adj}}(U_e) = U_e \otimes U_e^\dagger$ (2607.27935:main.tex:508-510, with the L -function at 2607.27935:main.tex:381 and its Bartholdi-deformed three-term formula at 2607.27935:main.tex:401-404). So the twisting representation of claim 3 is theirs, up to the column-stacking convention of Section 2.

Their construction admits loops and multiple edges: a loop contributes $X_e + X_e^{-1}$ to the weighted adjacency matrix and 2 to the degree. Specialising to the bouquet with $n_V = 1$, $n_E = D/2$, $K = n^2$ and graph degree D , the exponent $(n_V - n_E)K$ of their eq. (2.11) becomes $-n^2(D - 2)/2$, the bracket becomes $1 - uA_X + (D - 1)u^2$ with $A_X = \sum_i \bar{U}_i \otimes U_i = D\Phi = \Sigma$, and inverting eq. (2.8) turns ζ_X^{-1} into $\det(1 - uT)$. That is Equation (4), so the note records the verdict SAME for claims 1 and 3. The companion paper [29] carries the same adjoint weights into a matrix-weighted Bartholdi zeta, of which the Ihara case is one value of the Bartholdi parameter, and is SAME by the same route; [30] and [31] are the loci above.

11.4 Watanabe and Fukumizu

Cited fact 11.3 (Ihara–Bass for arbitrary matrix weights, loopless). [cited] The edge zeta is built from matrix weights $\{u_e\}_{e \in E}$ with $u_e \in \text{Mat}_{r_t(e) \times r_o(e)}$, with the cycle weight $\pi(\frac{p}{q}) := u_{e_1} \cdots u_{e_k}$ (1103.0605:section3.tex:307-310 and 1103.0605:section3.tex:315), and the corollary `cor:IBfornonhyper` reads $Z_G(\{u\})^{-1} = \det(I + \hat{\mathcal{M}}_{\{D\}}(\{u\}) - \hat{\mathcal{M}}_{\{A\}}(\{u\})) \prod_{e \in E} \det(I - u_e u_{\bar{e}})$, (1103.0605:section3.tex:333-335), of which the authors say Corollary `\ref{cor:IBfornonhyper}` gives the extension of the result to graphs with arbitrary weights. (1103.0605:section3.tex:373). No inverse relation is imposed between u_e and $u_{\bar{e}}$, which is the feature Theorem 10.1 needs.

Their graphs are hypergraphs, A *hypergraph* $\mathcal{H} = (V, F)$ consists of a set of *vertices* V and a set of *hyperedges* F . (1103.0605:section2.tex:17-18), whose hyperedges are subsets of V of size two: no loops and no multiple edges, so a bouquet is not one of their graphs. Theorem 10.1 is the loop-admitting analogue of the corollary, of the same shape after $u_e = u\mathcal{E}_e$, but the corollary does not cover the bouquet and its scalar reduction does

not evaluate correctly there; the note also records that the hypergraph-free proof it points to (the NeurIPS 2009 supplement) was not fetched. Verdict RELATED: the closest prior art for arbitrary weights, not a special case, and with no representation-theoretic or quantum reading [36].

11.5 Bordenave and Collins

Cited fact 11.4 (Matrix-valued non-backtracking operator, no zeta). [cited]The operator is $B = \sum_{j \neq i} a_j \otimes S_i \otimes E_{ij}$, (1801.00876:tenseur9.tex:784), introduced because Our proof relies on the development of a matrix version of the non-backtracking operator theory and a refined trace method. (1801.00876:tenseur9.tex:158), and aimed at this application: This extension is especially relevant in the context of quantum expanders. (1801.00876:tenseur9.tex:165). The only place the tradition names the identity is in the later work, This formula is closely related to various spectral identities known as Ihara-Bass identities (2304.05714:PT-RC_reloaded.tex:2568). The same operator as T , then, and the spectral correspondence, but as a resolvent identity rather than a determinant: no zeta and no Riemann hypothesis.

The verdict is RELATED. The follow-ups are [5] for general unitaries and [4] for the operator-valued identity; [3] also records, at 1801.00876:tenseur9.tex:608–610, that a family of tensor-squared permutations is a nearly optimal quantum expander in Hastings’ sense.

11.6 Hastings and Harrow

Cited fact 11.5 (Transfer of the spectral gap from a Cayley graph). [cited] $\lambda_2(\mathcal{E}) \leq \lambda_2(W_\Gamma)$. (0709.1142:main.tex:213), under the dictionary degree becomes the number of Kraus operators, the spectral gap becomes the gap of the quantum operation (0709.1142:main.tex:72–73). Here λ_2 of the channel is its second largest singular value as a map on density matrices and λ_2 of W_Γ that of the Cayley graph transition matrix, so taking Γ to be LPS generators in $\text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ gives exactly Ramanujan channels from any irreducible representation.

The bound itself, $\lambda_H = 2\sqrt{D-1}/D$, is Hastings’ [19], quoted in Definition 3.17; that paper has no zeta and no non-backtracking operator, and the word Ramanujan does not occur in [17]. Verdict SAME for the mechanism behind claim 4, NOT for anything zeta-shaped.

11.7 Iyer, Jain, Jordan and Somma

Cited fact 11.6 (Exact Ramanujan quantum expanders from LPS). [cited]it is possible to construct exact Ramanujan quantum expanders from $SU(2)$ unitaries derived from the LPS construction~\cite{lubotzky1988ramanujan,harrow2007quantum}. (2602.15180:main.tex:1508), and, of the explicit construction, Our quantum circuits can be used to construct explicit Ramanujan quantum expanders, a longstanding open problem. (2602.15180:main.tex:241). The mechanism is the one of cited fact 11.5, carried by $SU(2)$ irreducible representations rather than by the Weil representation, and no zeta is attached.

Verdict RELATED for claim 4 [21]. The note records that their Appendix C example, $p = 5$ and $D = 6$, uses the same norm-5 quaternions as the script behind Section 7. Separately, [22] amplifies arbitrary expanders to almost Ramanujan ones, short of the bound and with no zeta: verdict NOT.

11.8 Quantum-walk zetas and the secondary sources

Cited fact 11.7 (Attribution of the twisted zeta and of the three-term formula). [cited] A zeta function of a regular graph G associated with a unitary representation of the fundamental group of G was developed by Sunada [Sunada1, Sunada2]. (2105.02677:main.tex:87–89); for graph coverings, Stark and Terras further introduced notions of *Galois coverings* and *Artin-Ihara L -functions* for graphs (2309.15873:AIM_Final.tex:131); and for the determinant, the three-term determinant formula from [Theorem 18.15]{Terras:2011} applied to the Artin-Ihara L -function (2405.04361:v3.tex:427). The twisted zeta is therefore Sunada’s [34], sharpened by Hashimoto [18] and Bass [1]; the L -function of a covering is Stark and Terras’ [33], with the three-term formula at Theorem 18.15 of [35]. None of these primary sources is local.

In Stark and Terras the representation is one of the Galois group of a covering of finite graphs, hence of a finite group, whereas $\text{Ad}(U_i)$ for generic unitaries generates an infinite group: the object of Definition 3.18 is not literally a Stark–Terras L -function, although the determinant formula is the same. The secondary sources [12] and [16] serve this attribution only; verdict RELATED.

The quantum-walk zeta line [25], [24], [23] builds zetas from the unitary evolution matrix of a quantum walk rather than from Kraus operators, [24] extending to open quantum random walks on the torus by Fourier analysis; verdict NOT for claims 1 to 4, the value here being the Sunada pointer. Ben-Aroya, Schwartz and Ta-Shma [2] is the one unverified source near claim 2: an agent read from the publisher PDF that they believe their first construction has the potential of being improved to a quantum Ramanujan expander.

11.9 What was not found, and the limits of the search

Observation 11.8 (Verdict of the prior-art search). [sketched]

No source found attaches a zeta function, or an analogue of the Riemann hypothesis, to a quantum channel; none states that the poles of ζ_Φ lie on the critical circle if and only if Φ meets the Hastings bound λ_H ; none gives the matrix-product-state ring-norm reading or the identification of AKLT with K_4 . The Ad-weighted Ihara–Bass formula and the free-group L -function reading are known (cited facts 11.1 and 11.2), arbitrary matrix weights are known for loopless graphs (cited fact 11.3), and the matrix-valued non-backtracking operator is known (cited fact 11.4).

The consequence for this book: [30], [36] and the Sunada–Hashimoto line are cited for the object and the determinant, while the Ramanujan reading of Section 10, the dictionary of Section 8 and the Weil–LPS instance of Section 7 are this notebook’s own. Theorem 10.1 is the bouquet analogue of cited fact 11.3, proved there from scratch; no local source covers arbitrary non-invertible weights on a bouquet.

These arXiv metadata queries returned zero hits: "Ihara zeta" AND "quantum channel"; "Ihara zeta" AND "completely positive"; "zeta" AND "quantum expander"; "zeta" AND "Kraus operators"; abs:"zeta function" AND abs:"superoperator"; "Ruelle zeta" AND "quantum channel"; "Ihara" AND "matrix product state"; "AKLT" AND "zeta"; "non-backtracking" AND "superoperator"; "Ihara" AND ("quantum Ramanujan" OR "Ramanujan quantum"). Web and Scholar searches for the phrase quantum Ihara zeta, for Ihara zeta with noncommutative or quantum graphs (Weaver, Duan–Severini–Winter), for Ihara zeta with matrix product states or tensor networks, and a MathOverflow search for Ihara zeta and quantum expanders, returned nothing on point. The standing limit: arXiv search is metadata-only, so a formula inside a paper body would not surface, and the absence claims of observation 11.8 are weaker than its presence claims.

11.10 Corrections

One agent attributed arXiv:2309.15873 to Kudo and Li. The $\text{\TeX}$ header of the local source, at 2309.15873:AIM_Final.tex:86,90, gives the authors as Mason Eyler and Jaiung Jun; [12] and every citation of it were corrected on the evening of 2026-09-12.

12 The Continuous Dictionary

TJO's question: replace channels by Lindblad generators. The simplest continuous instance is the generator of rotations on a circle of circumference $\log p$, whose trace is a Poisson comb at multiples of $\log p$; the Selberg analogue should be a Lindbladian built from the vector fields on $\mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{R})$, with the Laplacian as the small operator, and a formal analogue of the comb. This section records what survives when the statements are written down and proved. The proofs are in `notes/selberg/astra-proofs.md`, authored by the second model family (codex, `gpt-6-astra`, reasoning effort xhigh) as a constructive prover from the brief `notes/selberg/astra-brief.md`, and reviewed adversarially by a Claude Opus refuter; the symbolic and numerical checks are in `scripts/selberg_lindblad.py`. Conventions: Definitions 4.18 to 4.23; $\Delta = -y^2(\partial_x^2 + \partial_y^2)$ is positive; Γ is torsion-free and cocompact except in the modular computation.

12.1 Standard inputs

Six facts are used as assumptions, printed as such because no local source quotes them in full; every claim below that depends on one prints `-conditional`.

Assumption 12.1 (Fuchsian geometry).

[assumed]

A torsion-free cocompact Fuchsian group acts freely and properly discontinuously on $\mathbb{H}$; primitive hyperbolic conjugacy classes correspond to primitive oriented closed geodesics with period equal to translation length; hyperbolic balls have area $2\pi(\cosh R - 1)$.

Assumption 12.2 (Laplace spectrum of a compact surface). [assumed] Δ on a connected compact hyperbolic surface has discrete spectrum $0 = \lambda_0 < \lambda_1 \leq \dots \rightarrow \infty$, written $\lambda_j = \frac{1}{4} + r_j^2$ with $r_j \geq 0$ real for $\lambda_j \geq \frac{1}{4}$, $r_j = i\nu_j$ with $0 < \nu_j < \frac{1}{2}$ for $0 < \lambda_j < \frac{1}{4}$, and $r_0 = i/2$.

Assumption 12.3 (Selberg zeta is entire with known divisor).

[assumed] Z_{Sel} extends

to an entire function with zero divisor $\sum_{j \geq 0} ([\frac{1}{2} + ir_j] + [\frac{1}{2} - ir_j]) + (2g - 2) \sum_{n \geq 0} (2n + 1)[-n]$ and no other zeros or poles.

Assumption 12.4 (Closed realisations).

[assumed] Complete volume-preserving flows

have skew-adjoint unitary generators, and Δ on a compact manifold has its self-adjoint realisation and heat semigroup.

Assumption 12.5 (Standard facts about ζ).

[assumed] ζ continues meromorphically

with $\zeta(0) = -\frac{1}{2}$, $\zeta(1 + w) = 1/w + \gamma_E + O(w)$, the functional equation $\zeta(z) = \chi(z)\zeta(1 - z)$ with $\chi(z) = \pi^{z-1/2}\Gamma((1 - z)/2)/\Gamma(z/2)$, no zeros on $\mathrm{Re} z = 1$, and $|\zeta'/\zeta(1 + \epsilon + iv)| \leq C \log^2(3 + |v|)$ for $|v| \geq 1$, $0 \leq \epsilon \leq \epsilon_0$.

Assumption 12.6 (Standard facts about Γ).

[assumed] Γ is meromorphic

and zero-free with simple poles at the nonpositive integers, $\Gamma(\frac{1}{2}) = \sqrt{\pi}$, and (Γ'/Γ) has the Gauss integral representation and $O(\log)$ vertical growth in right half-planes.

12.2 Cited facts

Cited fact 12.7 (Guillemin flat trace formula).

[cited] Dyatlov and Zworski

[10] state, for an Anosov flow, $\mathrm{tr} \, e^{-itP} = \sum_{\gamma} \frac{T_{\gamma} \, \delta(t - T_{\gamma})}{|\det(I - \mathcal{P}_{\gamma})|}$, $\forall t > 0$ (1306.4203:zeta.tex:260-264, sum over closed orbits including repetitions, $T_{\gamma}^{\#}$ the primitive period). In our notation this is Definition 4.20.

The correction to the worklog's wording: the prime comb is an orbital (locally finite) trace, and the phrase “Poisson trace of the direct sum” does not name a trace-class operator. The missing ingredient is transverse expansion: a circle has no Poincaré map, so no Jacobian, so no resonances.

12.4 The Lindbladian of the vector fields is the Casimir, and the Laplacian on the K -invariant sector

Proposition 12.17 (Multiplication observables see a sum of squares). *[proved]* For real vector fields X_j acting as derivations of a smooth function algebra and jump operators $L_j = -iX_j$, on a common invariant domain, $\sum_j (L_j M_f L_j - \frac{1}{2}\{L_j^2, M_f\}) = -\frac{1}{2} \sum_j [L_j, [L_j, M_f]] = M_{\frac{1}{2} \sum_j X_j^2} f$; with the plus sign, since the X_j are formally anti-self-adjoint.

Proposition 12.18 (Casimir on the K -invariant sector). *[proved]* For right- K -invariant $f(g) = F(g \cdot i)$: $\mathbf{W}f = 0$, $\Omega f = y^2(F_{xx} + F_{yy})$ (the constant is $c = 1$), and $\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{H}^2 + \mathbf{E}^2)f = 2\Omega f = -2\Delta F$. On all functions $\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{H}^2 + \mathbf{E}^2) = 2\Omega + \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{W}^2$: the Casimir carries the compact direction with a minus sign and is not a diffusion Lindbladian on all of $L^2(\Gamma \backslash G)$; the two-jump Lindbladian with $L_1 = -i\mathbf{H}$, $L_2 = -i\mathbf{E}$ preserves the K -invariant sector and equals -2Δ there.

The second-order computation is the whole content: along $g_{x,y} \exp(u\mathbf{H}) \cdot i = x + iye^{2u}$ and $g_{x,y} \exp(u\mathbf{E}) \cdot i = x + y \tanh 2u + iy \operatorname{sech} 2u$, one finds $\mathbf{H}^2 f = 4y^2 F_{yy} + 4y F_y$ and $\mathbf{E}^2 f = 4y^2 F_{xx} - 4y F_y$, and the first-order drifts cancel. Squaring the projected tangent vectors alone would miss the drift and give the wrong operator.

Proposition 12.19 (The quantum Lindbladian of a representation). *[proved]* For a unitary representation π with anti-self-adjoint generators $A_j = d\pi(X_j)$ and jumps $L_j = -iA_j$, on finite-rank smooth operators, $\sum_j (L_j X L_j - \frac{1}{2}\{L_j^2, X\}) = \frac{1}{2} \sum_j B_j^2 X$ with $B_j X = [A_j, X]$ the generators of $\pi \otimes \bar{\pi}$ on Hilbert–Schmidt operators; for $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ and the two non-compact jumps it is $2\Omega_{\pi \otimes \bar{\pi}} + \frac{1}{2}B_W^2$, equal to $2\Omega_{\pi \otimes \bar{\pi}}$ on diagonal- K -invariant operators.

This is the continuous Harrow construction: a channel from a representation becomes a Lindbladian from a representation, and its gap is a question about $\pi \otimes \bar{\pi}$.

Conjecture 12.20 (Gap of the representation Lindbladian). *[open]* For an irreducible unitary π of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$, or of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$, the two-jump Lindbladian $2\Omega_{\pi \otimes \bar{\pi}} + \frac{1}{2}B_W^2$ has a spectral gap governed by the decomposition of $\pi \otimes \bar{\pi}$; for the Weil representation this is the continuous shadow of the Weil–LPS channels of Section 7.

13 The Continuous Dictionary II: Selberg Tower and the Cusp Comb

Continuation of Section 12, same conventions and the same proof file `notes/selberg/astra-proofs.md`.

13.1 The geodesic flow: continuous Ihara–Bass

Proposition 13.1 (Poincaré Jacobian).

[proved]

For a closed geodesic of length ℓ the linearised Poincaré map on $\mathfrak{sl}_2/\mathbb{R}H$ is $\text{Ad}(a_\ell^{-1})$ with multipliers $e^\ell, e^{-\ell}$, so $|\det(1 - P_\gamma^k)| = (e^{k\ell} - 1)(1 - e^{-k\ell}) = 4 \sinh^2(k\ell/2) = e^{k\ell}(1 - e^{-k\ell})^2$; the circle has an empty transverse space and factor 1.

Proposition 13.2 (Flat trace, Selberg tower, sign).

[proved-conditional] For

$\text{Re } \varsigma > 0$, $\Lambda_\text{fl}(\varsigma) = \sum_\gamma \sum_{k \geq 1} \ell_\gamma e^{-\varsigma k \ell_\gamma} / (4 \sinh^2(k \ell_\gamma / 2))$ converges absolutely, the tower $D_{\text{tow}}(\varsigma) = \prod_{j \geq 1} Z_{\text{Sel}}(\varsigma + j) = \prod_\gamma \prod_{m \geq 0} (1 - e^{-(\varsigma+m+1)\ell_\gamma})^{m+1}$ converges absolutely without zeros, and $\Lambda_\text{fl} = +D'_{\text{tow}}/D_{\text{tow}}$, equivalently $D_{\text{tow}}(\varsigma) = \exp\left(-\int_0^\infty t^{-1} e^{-\varsigma t} \text{Tr}^b e^{-t\mathcal{X}} dt\right)$.

The tower comes from $1/(4 \sinh^2(x/2)) = \sum_{m \geq 0} (m+1) e^{-(m+1)x}$: the Jacobian of the two transverse directions is what a graph does not have. The sign was drafted as a minus and is a plus; the graph counterpart of D_{tow} is $\det(1 - uT)$, not the zeta.

Proposition 13.3 (Divisor of the tower and the first band). [proved-conditional] D_{tow} continues to an entire function whose zeros are $\varsigma = -\frac{1}{2} - k \pm ir_j$ ($k, j \geq 0$) and $\varsigma = -N$ ($N \geq 1$) with order $(2g-2)N^2 + 2$; Λ_fl has simple poles there with residue the order. The nonconstant first band $\mathcal{B}_0$ is exactly the pole multiset in $-1 < \text{Re } \varsigma < 0$, and $\mathcal{B}_0 \subset \{\text{Re } \varsigma = -\frac{1}{2}\}$ iff every r_j , $j \geq 1$, is real iff Δ has no eigenvalue in $(0, \frac{1}{4})$.

The constant mode has $r_0 = i/2$ and contributes $\varsigma = 0$ and -1 ; it must be removed, exactly as the constant adjacency mode is removed in the Ramanujan condition of a graph. With it removed, the continuous Ramanujan property is Selberg's $\frac{1}{4}$ property, and the band structure is the one Dyatlov, Faure and Guillarmou prove for the operator-theoretic resonances (cited fact 12.8); Proposition 13.3 makes no claim about operator realisations, only about the poles of the continued Λ_fl .

Proposition 13.4 (Graph comparison and the Ruelle quotient).

[proved-conditional] For a

finite graph with Hashimoto matrix T , $\text{Tr } T^m = \sum_\gamma \sum_{k \ell_\gamma = m} \ell_\gamma$ and $\det(1 - uT) = \prod_\gamma (1 - u^{\ell_\gamma})$, with no Jacobian and no tower, and $\partial_\varsigma \log \det(1 - e^{-\varsigma} T) = \sum_m \text{Tr } T^m e^{-\varsigma m}$ has the sign of $\partial_\varsigma \log D_{\text{tow}}$. For the surface, $\zeta_R(s) = Z_{\text{Sel}}(s)/Z_{\text{Sel}}(s+1)$ (telescoping the product) and $D_{\text{tow}}(\varsigma)/D_{\text{tow}}(\varsigma+1) = Z_{\text{Sel}}(\varsigma+1)$.

13.2 The cusp of the modular surface is the prime comb

Proposition 13.5 (Exact Fourier identity for the scattering multiplier). [proved-conditional] m_{sc} is real, even, smooth and of polynomial growth, and

$$C_{\text{cusp}} = -P + A_{\text{arch}}, \quad P(t) = \sum_{n \geq 2} \frac{\Lambda(n)}{n} [\delta(t - 2 \log n) + \delta(t + 2 \log n)],$$

where $\langle A_{\text{arch}}, h \rangle = \frac{1}{2} \int h - (\gamma_E + \log \pi) h(0) + \int_0^\infty \frac{e^{-u} h(0) - \frac{1}{2} e^{-u/2} (h(u) + h(-u))}{1 - e^{-u}} du$, so $A_{\text{arch}}(t) = \frac{1}{2} - 1/(4 \sinh(|t|/2))$ away from 0. The prime atoms are dips; the constant $\frac{1}{2}$ is the pole of ζ at 1 (the ordinary boundary value of $\zeta'/\zeta(1+2ir) + \zeta'/\zeta(1-2ir)$ differs from its Abel boundary distribution by $\pi \delta_0$), not a digamma term.

The route: $\varphi'/\varphi(s) = (\Gamma'/\Gamma)(s - \frac{1}{2}) - (\Gamma'/\Gamma)(s) + 2\zeta'/\zeta(2s - 1) - 2\zeta'/\zeta(2s)$; the functional equation moves $\zeta'/\zeta(2ir)$ to $-\zeta'/\zeta(1 - 2ir)$ plus Gamma terms, and the $(\Gamma'/\Gamma)(ir)$ terms cancel exactly, leaving $m_{\text{sc}} = a + b$ with $b(r) = \zeta'/\zeta(1 + 2ir) + \zeta'/\zeta(1 - 2ir)$; the Dirichlet series of b at $1 + \epsilon$ transforms termwise to the comb, and the $\epsilon \downarrow 0$ limit produces $-\pi\delta_0$ on the frequency side.

Numerical result 13.6 (Symbolic and numerical checks).

[numerical]

`scripts/selberg_lindblad.py` (output `outputs/selberg_lindblad.txt`): exact symplectic, Lindbladian $= \frac{1}{2}X^2$; the left-invariant fields derived from the Iwasawa coordinates satisfy the $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ brackets, and on K -invariant F : $Hf = 2yF_y$, $Ef = 2yF_x$, $Wf = 0$, $(H^2 + E^2)f = 4y^2(F_{xx} + F_{yy})$, constant $c = +1$, Lindblad constant 2; quantum tensor identity to $7 \cdot 10^{-15}$, and for the three-dimensional $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ irrep the Lindbladian spectrum is $\{0, -4^{\times 3}, -12^{\times 5}\} = -2j(j+1)$; Poincaré determinant $2 - 2\cosh(k\ell)$, absolute value $4\sinh^2(k\ell/2)$; cusp transform with a Gaussian window ($G_w = 40$, $R = 6G_w$): dips at $2\log n$ with amplitude ratio to $\Lambda(n)/n$ of mean -31.91545 , spread 10^{-3} , against the predicted $-2G_w/\sqrt{2\pi} = -31.91538$; residual after the exact archimedean background and the additive constant is $3 \cdot 10^{-8}$ over $t \in [0.5, 7]$. The constant came out as 1 because the script's multiplier is $-\text{Re}(\varphi'/\varphi)$, twice m_{sc} .

Proposition 13.7 (What the rate- $\frac{1}{4}$ damping identifies).

[proved-conditional] On

$(0, \infty)$, $e^{-t/4}P_{\text{ch}} = P_+ = -(C_{\text{cusp}} - A_{\text{arch}})|_{(0, \infty)}$. This is an equality of prime atomic measures after subtracting A_{arch} and choosing positive weights; it is not an equality of the full cusp distribution with a semigroup trace, nor of operators or spectra, and it implies nothing about the Riemann hypothesis.

The sentence in the previous session, “the cusp term of the modular trace formula is the trace of the Riemann channel damped at rate $\frac{1}{4}$ ”, is therefore corrected: what is proved is that the prime measure written in the Riemann-channel note, damped at rate $\frac{1}{4}$, is the prime part of the cusp distribution. The full trace of $Z(t)$ is not established as a pure prime comb (its own explicit formula has pole, archimedean and sign bookkeeping), and the rate $\frac{1}{4}$ is the uniform rate only under the Riemann hypothesis.

13.3 The dictionary

Observation 13.8 (Continuous dictionary).

[sketched-conditional] Row by row: edge

space $\leftrightarrow \Gamma \backslash G$; Hashimoto operator $T \leftrightarrow$ geodesic generator $\mathcal{X}$; adjacency $A \leftrightarrow$ Casimir Ω , equal to $-\Delta$ on the K -invariant sector; Ihara–Bass $\det(1 - uT) = (1 - u^2)^{|E|-|V|} \det(1 - uA + qu^2) \leftrightarrow$ the tower $D_{\text{tow}} = \prod_{j \geq 1} Z_{\text{Sel}}(\zeta + j)$ with zeros in the bands $-\frac{1}{2} - k \pm ir_j$; Ramanujan $\leftrightarrow$ no eigenvalue in $(0, \frac{1}{4})$; the primes of ζ enter only through the cusp of the modular surface, as the scattering term, not as closed geodesics.

discrete	continuous	where
edge space $\mathcal{W}$	$\Gamma \backslash \text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{R})$	Definition 4.18
T	$\mathcal{X} = H/2$	Definition 4.18
$\text{Tr } T^m$ (no Jacobian)	$\text{Tr}^b e^{-t\mathcal{X}}$, weights $1/4 \sinh^2$	Propositions 13.1 and 13.4
$A, \Sigma = D\Phi$	$\Omega, -2\Delta$ on K -invariants	Proposition 12.18
$\det(1 - uT)$	$D_{\text{tow}}(\zeta)$, sign $+D'_{\text{tow}}/D_{\text{tow}}$	Proposition 13.2
$\mu\mu' = q$	bands $-\frac{1}{2} - k \pm ir_j$	Proposition 13.3
Ramanujan	$\text{spec } \Delta \cap (0, \frac{1}{4}) = \emptyset$	Proposition 13.3
mixed-unitary channel	two-jump Lindbladian of $\pi \otimes \bar{\pi}$	Proposition 12.19
primes as rings	cusp term, dips $\Lambda(n)/n$ at $2\log n$	Proposition 13.5

13.4 Not established

A literal operator-theoretic compression from $\Gamma \backslash G$ to the K -invariant sector that turns D_{tow} into a Laplacian determinant (the continuous Ihara–Bass as an identity of operators rather than of divisors); an anisotropic-space realisation of the trace resonances; a trace formula for the full compressed semigroup $Z(t)$; any gap for conjecture [12.20](#); anything about the Riemann hypothesis or the $\frac{1}{4}$ property of a given surface.

14 Open Problems and Dead Routes

Dead routes are results. Both lists mirror `HANDOFF.md`, which is the live version.

14.1 Open problems, in order

Conjecture 14.1 (Ramanujan without unitarity). *[open]* *There is a Ramanujan-type reading of the poles of ζ_T for non-unitary Kraus families, replacing the relation $\mu\mu' = q$ of the unitary case, and canonical form $\sum_k A_k^\dagger A_k = 1$ constrains the poles.*

What is known: Theorem 10.1 replaces qu^2 by the operator $\mathcal{D}(u)$ and $u\Sigma$ by the deformed channel $\mathcal{A}(u)$, both built from $(1 - u^2 \text{Ad}(A_k^\dagger A_k))^{-1}$, so no quadratic relation pairs the eigenvalues of T with those of Σ . Cheap next step: a random-MPS pole-radius hunt (bond dimension 2 to 4, physical dimension 2) to see whether the poles cluster on one circle at all.

Stinespring form of the compressed semigroup. Conjecture 6.9 (stated in Section 6): a Stinespring form of $Z(t)$ on K_S whose Kraus (jump) operators are the prime dilations.

The single-Kraus lift exists trivially. A Holevo-form covariant Lindbladian with the von Mangoldt jump measure lives on the full regular representation, has symbol ζ^t , and is not the compressed object. A negative answer with a reason is a result. Suggested route (HANDOFF step 2): write $Z(t)$ explicitly through Cauchy kernels and test a generator of Holevo jump form with jumps at $k \log p$ on K_S , blind, in a second model family.

Hecke identification of the Weil–LPS spectra. Conjecture 7.4 (stated in Section 7): the joint spectra of the commuting channels $\Phi_q^\pm$ are Hecke eigenvalues of weight-2 forms for the quaternion algebra ramified at $\{2, \infty\}$, via Jacquet–Langlands.

Needs LMFDB and the Jacquet–Langlands bookkeeping; the visible structure (joint eigenvalue pairs, small-degree algebraic integers, multiplicities equal to those of irreducibles of $\text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ in $W_\pm \otimes \overline{W}_\pm$) is consistent with it.

Conjecture 14.2 (Assembling over p). *[open]* *The Weil–LPS channels for different p assemble into one object whose rings are the primes and whose transfer spectrum is the zeros of ζ .*

This is the parent campaign’s DG-GLOBAL question in this guise. Nothing is known beyond the obstruction recorded below.

14.2 Dead routes

Observation 14.3 (Prime-by-prime ansätze are blind to zeros). *[sketched]* The direct sum over primes of rotations on circles of circumference $\log p$ has trace $\sum_n \Lambda(n) \delta(s - \log n)$ by Poisson summation and dynamical zeta equal to the Euler product; for any finite set S of primes its spectrum is the set of poles of the partial Euler product. The same holds for product states and commuting dilations. Zeros exist only in the infinite product, so no prime-by-prime ansatz can see them.

Recorded 2026-09-12 from the circle-flow discussion. Two remarks kept: in the Witt convention $L_1 - L_{-1}$ is the dilation flow (source and sink) and L_0 the rotation; the only relation between primes is additive.

Further routes closed or flagged in the founding session: the functional integral framing of Selberg as a continuum limit (TJO: too far); calling $-\log E$ the entanglement Hamiltonian (an error,

corrected in observation [5.7](#)); an algebraic-integer recognition of the Weil–LPS joint eigenvalues from five-digit output (tautological, since the adjacency matrix is integral); the Dwork transfer operator as a route to the Riemann hypothesis for curves (observation [8.4](#)).

15 Reproducibility Map

Every numerical claim in this book points to a script under `scripts/` whose standard output is captured under `outputs/`. All scripts run from the repository root with `python3` and need only `numpy`, `scipy`, `mpmath` and `sympy`. Random data are seeded. The local CI re-runs the fast scripts and diffs their output against the captured files.

script	what it establishes	output, claims
<code>qihara.py</code>	Quantum Ihara–Bass identity for Haar-random unitary Kraus sets, $(n, D) = (3, 4), (4, 6)$, at complex u ; Ramanujan check of Σ	<code>outputs/qihara.txt</code> ; <code>num:qihara-unitary</code>
<code>bcmpo.py</code>	Bost–Connes phase operators $e(a/b)$ as MPOs over the prime chain against Hurwitz-zeta sums; character-sector transfer eigenvalues against $L(\beta, \bar{\chi})/\zeta(\beta)$	<code>outputs/bcmpo.txt</code> ; <code>num:bc-mpo</code>
<code>scat.py</code>	Unimodularity of $S(\tau)$, its zeros at $\gamma_n/2 - i/4$, contractivity in the lower half plane, prime-phase identity	<code>outputs/scat.txt</code> ; <code>num:scattering-symbol</code>
<code>ringnorm.py</code>	Windowed sum over the first 3000 zeros against the full explicit formula; dips at $\log n$ of depth $\Lambda(n)/\sqrt{n}$	<code>outputs/ringnorm.txt</code> ; <code>num:ringnorm-3000</code>
<code>weil_lps.py</code>	Weil–LPS channels for $(p; q)$ in seven cases: intertwining check, Ramanujan bound, Harrow containment, Hecke relations, commutation, joint spectra	<code>outputs/weil_lps_p*.txt</code> ; <code>num:weil-lps-ramanujan</code>
<code>weil_lps_hashimoto.py</code>	Direct edge superoperator for $(13, 17)$, odd block: Ihara–Bass to 10^{-14} , moduli $\{17, \sqrt{17}, 1\}$	<code>outputs/weil_lps_hashimoto_p13_q17_odd.t</code> ; <code>num:weil-lps-rh</code>
<code>artin_schreier_mps.py</code>	Brute-force exponential sums against $\text{Tr } E^n$ for quadratic Artin–Schreier data; $EE^\dagger = qI$	<code>outputs/artin_schreier_mps.txt</code> ; <code>num:artin-schreier-mps</code>
<code>qihara_general.py</code>	Theorem 10.1 in both forms, five configurations, float to 10^{-15} and exact rational arithmetic	<code>outputs/qihara_general.txt</code> ; <code>num:qihara-general</code>

Data

`data/zeros3000.npy`: the first 3000 imaginary parts of the zeta zeros, from `mpmath.zetazero`.

`data/ringnorm.npy`: the arrays of the ring-norm test.

Reference sources

`refs/fetch_sources.sh` downloads the arXiv TeX source of every cited paper into `refs/src/<id>/` (not redistributed) and writes `refs/manifest.sha256`. Every quote in `db/provenance.tsv` is byte-checked by the gate at its stated `<id>:<file>:<line>`.

Reviews

`notes/reviews/` holds the adversarial review reports; a `proved` claim names its review file in `db/claims.tsv` and the gate checks that the file contains `VERDICT <id>: VALID`.

16 Lab Log

The dated worklogs under `docs/worklog/` are the primary chronology; `HANDOFF.md` is the live state. This section is their mirror at the level of decisions.

2026-09-10/11: founding session

One conversation in the parent repository `arithmetic-quantum-mechanics`. Trajectory: Bost–Connes basics; why not Wick-rotate to Hilbert–Pólya; an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{F}_2$ as a finite instance; permutations and the one determinant identity; automata and rationality; the actual Riemann hypothesis as a flow with orbit periods $\log p$; the Ihara zeta of regular graphs as the vestigial Selberg zeta; Shor’s unitary as the level- N Galois symmetry of Bost–Connes; quantum expanders and the quantum Ihara zeta; matrix-product states and the ring-norm reading; the Bost–Connes system as a matrix-product operator over the prime chain; the Holevo–Werner lift; and the computation of the scattering symbol, its zeros, and the 3000-zero ring-norm test.

Corrections TJO made along the way, kept as working rules: stay elementary, no jargon dumps, one step at a time; no curves or field extensions when a permutation will do; “QFT” did not mean functional integrals; length quantisation should come from a flatness-type condition.

Afternoon: the Weil–LPS channels computed for seven primes. Bugs found and fixed: quaternion enumeration starting at an odd coordinate (caught by the divisor-sum count); parity as a second fixed point on the full space (resolved by splitting into the two Weil blocks); the Hecke relation failing on SL_2 by signs (resolved on PSL_2).

Evening: the matrix-product formulation of the Weil conjectures for quadratic Artin–Schreier curves. Bugs: a wrong irreducibility test for composite n ; the even- n sign, which was the L -function normalisation, not a bug.

2026-09-12

Morning: circle flows discussed (no code); the expository note on Deligne’s proof written; repository made public under AGPL-3.0.

Afternoon: prior-art search on the quantum Ihara zeta, three Opus literature agents, then byte-verification against arXiv TeX sources (`refs/`). Finding: the object and its determinant formula are known (Matsuura–Ohta; Watanabe–Fukumizu for loopless graphs; Sunada); the RH-for-channels reading, the MPS dictionary and the Weil-representation instance were not found. Then the Ihara–Bass formula for arbitrary Kraus families proved in Lamport style and taken through two rounds of adversarial review by Opus reviewers; promoted to **proved**. Standing preference recorded: TeX source, not PDF, for every quotation.

Evening: this lab book set up following the parent repository’s sharded pattern, with the notation, definitions, claims and provenance databases under `db/`, the generated macro and status files, the gate `scripts/labbook_check.py`, the local CI `scripts/ci_local.sh` and its pre-commit hook. Notation and definitions across the seven notes de-duplicated into the databases; the clashes and their resolutions are listed in Section 2.

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